

Mythic Japan: Ukiyo-e

Japanese setting for Free League's Vaesen

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Contents

Introduction 4
- Welcome to Mythic Japan 4
- Ukiyo 4
- Mythic Japan 4
- Hi-ningenteki na ikemono (inhuman creatures) 5
- Daisan no Me (The Third Eye) 5
- The Six Principles 6
- Your player character in Mythic Japan 8
- Transition and Tradition - which are you? 8
- Gender roles in Japanese society 8
- Status 9
- Mementos 10

Your Mythic Japan 12
- Life in the City 13
- Important Cities in Meiji Period Japan 14
- Communication and Travel 16

Daisan no me no taisei (The Society of the Third Eye) 18
- The First Scholar 19
- The Second Scholar 20
- The Third Scholar 21
- The End and New Beginnings 22

Archetypes 23
- Academic 24
- Warrior 25
- Criminal 26
- Doctor 27
- Entertainer 28
- Hunter 29
- Police 30
- shrine maiden / shaman 31
- Officer 32
- Priest 33
- Servant 34
- Writer 35

Talents and Equipment 36
- General Talents 37
- Archetype Talents 37
- Equipment and Services 39

Conflict - Key Themes to Drive Adventures 41
- Human on Human Conflict 42
- The Conflict between Hi-ningenteki and Humans 43

Yurei, Yokai, and Oni 45
- The supernatural and Japanese Society 45
- Ameonna (Rain Woman) 46
- Inugami (Dog God) 48
- Jurogomo (Spider Wife) 50
- Kappa (River Yokai) 52
- Kawuso (Otter) 54
- Kitsune (Fox Wife) 56
- Korori (Cholera Plague Spirit) 58
- Rokokubi (Long Necked Woman) 60
- Tengu (Mountain Spirit) 62
- Tesso the Rat 64
- Wanyudo (Flaming Monk) 66
- Yuki Onna (Snow Maiden) 68

Life Paths 70
- The Great Shift 84

Introduction

WELCOME TO MYTHIC JAPAN

You arrive at Nagoya, a city on the railway line between Kyoto and Edo - or as it is now known, Tokyo. From the corner of your eye you see a rickshaw being pulled by a small Japanese man. In the back seat you spot a foreign officer, no doubt French or Prussian, brought here to train the troops of the Emperor. As the rickshaw pulls away, you take in other people on the road - an industrialist rushing to some critical meeting no doubt, a shrine maiden wanders aimlessly across the road.

A train conductor, with his new peaked cap and heavy blue overcoat, approaches you from his office. "Are you lost?", he asks. His hands are soft, his eyes sharp, and you cannot help but wonder, did this man not carry two swords until recently? "No", you reply, "We have a letter from the Lady of the Castle. She has requested our attendance". Gathering your things, you hail a rickshaw of your own. "To the castle, and be quick about it", you command the driver.

As the rickshaw makes its way up the hill towards the castle, you observe the many sights in the distance. You can hear the sounds of industry and commerce, new silk factories operating around the clock to provide the wealth Japan needs in order to gain influence. Along the road, artisans practice crafts as they have for centuries, slowly hand crafting works of beauty as is the way of old. As you approach the castle, its rundown nature surprises you. From this place the great Tokugawa clan - the Owari, have ruled for centuries. But now it has clearly fallen on troubled times.

Along the walls of the castle you see great Camphor trees reaching into the sky. At that moment you notice a small face - beautiful and haunting amongst the branches. Her face, for it is clearly a she, is framed with the most vivid red hair. Why a woman of such beauty would choose to hide in the branches - you have no idea. The woman opens her mouth and yawns, showing you small, sharp pointed teeth. You see her startle as she realizes you can see her and with a sudden movement - she disappears into the branches, leaving you with a glimpse of many tails.

UKIYO

Welcome to Ukiyo - a game set in Mythic Japan, and an expansion for Vaesen, Free League's outstanding mystery/horror game. Ukiyo is a word with two meanings in Japanese, both of which speak to the nature of this game and the experience your characters will have as they explore Mythic Japan. First, The Floating World, represents the transience and change represented by the urban culture that is taking over Japan. Second, The Sorrowful World, captures the end of the tradition and the loss of certainty that is washing across Japan as a result of the Meiji Restoration. Like Vaesen, we have been informed by art in the creation of this game - in particular the work of Toyama Sekien, Katsushika Hokusai and Kobayashi Kiyochika. The work of these and other artists, commonly referred to as Ukiyo-e (Pictures of the Floating World), defines our view of Supernatural Japan for the game and captures the shift from the traditional world of the Tokugawa Shogunate to the industrialized Meiji period.

MYTHIC JAPAN

Mythic Japan is set during a period of great cultural change occurring over the second half of the 18th century, between 1850 and 1905. In this period Japan will transform from a feudal agrarian society to a fully industrialized major power. Japanese culture will be upended - overturning 265 years of rule by the Tokugawa Shogunate and ending the defined hierarchy of caste that the Shogunate had worked so hard to enshrine.

Norms will be destroyed, liberal and conservative forces will clash many times, and the differences between rural and urban societies will become exacerbated. Modernization will take on religious fervor, actively supported by a government terrified that it will be conquered like its neighbors by foreign powers. Trade and industrialization will come to dominate a society that had previously regarded classical education and rural production as its most important traits. Traditions will die and new ones will be born - angering the spirits who ensure bountiful harvests and good lives. The Society in this setting is seeking to reach a compromise

- allowing the best of both worlds, the old and new, to co-exist. Your characters work to put to rest dangerous spirits, find new solutions to old problems, and ensure that in its rush to modernize, Japan does not lose its very heart. At the same time other forces - both modernizers and traditionalists, seek to destroy your work for reasons both good and bad.

HI-NINGENTEKI NA IKEMONO

(INHUMAN CREATURES)

Japanese fairy tales are complex and diverse with a rich tapestry of Yurei, Yokai, Oni and Kami. This diversity is in part a result of a religious tradition that accepted the existence of the supernatural and found a place for them as opposed to the Western Christian tradition of demonizing and rejecting them. There are many ways to describe the supernatural creatures (known as either Choujouteki or Hi-ningenteki) of Japan but broadly the following groupings are relevant:

- Yurei: Ghosts and spirits of the dead, often returned from the grave to exact vengeance and punish the living.
- Yokai: Supernatural creatures that populate the countryside. From Tanuki to Kitsuni - these are the shapeshifters and tricksters of Japanese Lore.
- Oni: Demons, sometimes result of the corruption of humans, sometimes from one of the many Hells. Unlike Yurei and Yokai, Oni are evil seeking only to cause harm to people and things.
- Kami: The many thousands of gods and deities that exist throughout Japan - such as river, forest, and mountain spirits.

Rituals, prayers, special gifts, and traditional ways of doing things, are critical to appeasing the spirits or avoiding their attention. In many cases, this was well known only decades ago, but modernization and the emptying of the villages have already led to the loss of this knowledge. Even where rituals are understood and remembered, the spirits reject them - angered at the changes that have stripped them of their traditional role.



DAISAN NO ME (THE THIRD EYE)

Only decades ago many people could see the spirits. Acceptance of the supernatural was a key part of everyday life, so the ability to see the creatures was not uncommon. As modernization spread, the ability to see supernatural creatures has disappeared - a casualty of a changed mindset spreading through the population. You, however, are different. Some trauma in your life has unlocked your ability to see the Hi-ningenteki - your third eye, known as the Upper Tanden, has been opened and will never close. This ability is a curse and a blessing. Known in the west as Thursday's children, you are daisan no me ga iru hito (people of the third eye) - hunter of ghosts, and settler of spirits

THE SIX PRINCIPLES

1. **Hi-ningenteki are sometimes evil: But this is only true for the most demonic of Oni. Even then, they are fulfilling a role.** They act according to their nature and have desires, plans, and goals that are their own. Often the role or responsibility they are fulfilling extends well beyond the mortal realm. As with Vaesen - they always have a motive for their actions.

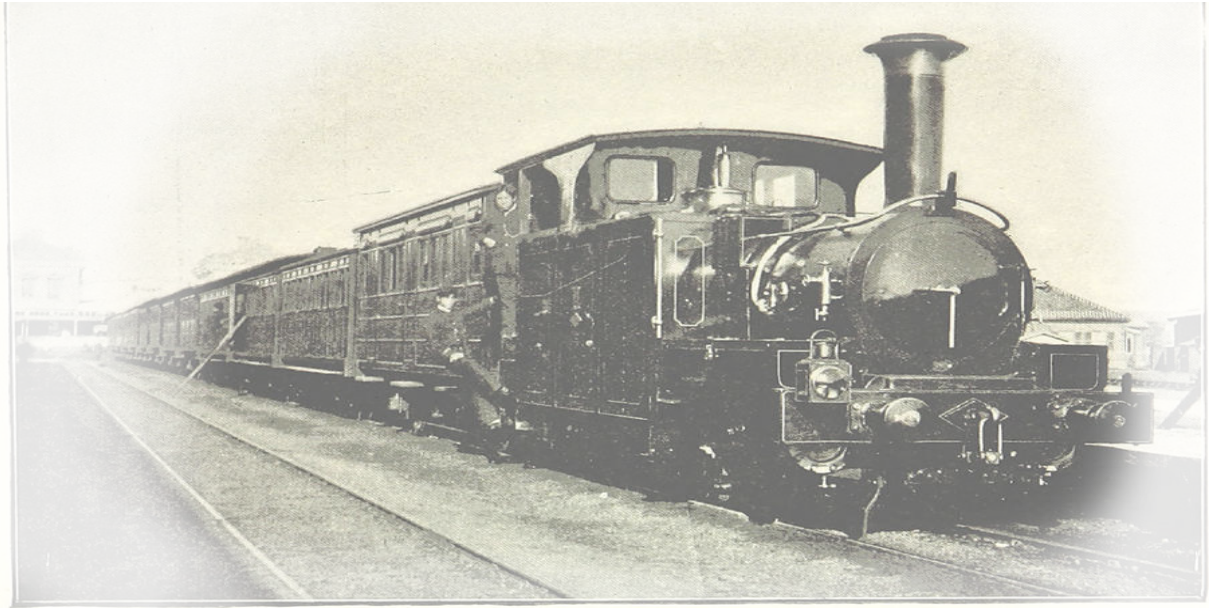
2. **Nature and the rural areas are different in both culture and acceptance of modern things from the modernizing cities:** Both represent an older, more traditional space, and are alien to the players who are located in urban environments and have access to modern technology and education. You are on your own in the wilderness and in the small villages at the edge of the rice paddies and forests.

3. **Japan is changing and the traditions and rules that have guided society for a thousand years are being overturned:** Bushi (Warriors) have lost their position of authority and the emperor has mandated the adoption of modern ways of doing things. Famine stalks the provinces and civil wars have broken out. The cities, throng with the destitute and poor, and the villages, are empty of the young. Hi-ningenteki have been forgotten and are seeking a place in this new world.

4. **Knowledge, cunning, and awareness of tradition are the keys to success:** Hi-ningenteki cannot be defeated or resolved with violence alone. Instead, you must use your abilities to study clues, understand the information you have gathered, and persuade both humans and Hi-ningenteki to share their secrets.

5. **The journey is part of the goal:** The mysteries are not merely problems to be solved or overcome – their whole point is to pull the players and the player characters into the story that emerges during the course of the game. Another important focus is each player character's journey from naive and untrained youngster to seasoned and experienced – and likely scarred – veteran.

6. **You will not survive without each other:** The player characters will face creatures the mere sight of which can drive a person mad, and beasts that can kill with a single blow. The only way to survive is to stick together. The player characters' relationships with each other and with important NPCs are crucial - both to the story, and for healing physical and mental injuries sustained during the game.



Character Creation



YOUR PLAYER CHARACTER IN MYTHIC JAPAN

Vaesen is a game of terror and change, capturing the point in time when technology dramatically altered the landscape, people, and culture of the Scandinavian countries. In Japan, the rate of change, the nature of that change, and its final impact on people, culture, and landscape, were even more dramatic. Within two generations, Japan moved from being a feudal society to a modern limited democracy capable of defeating a significant western power in open conflict. Of course, this rate of change opens up tremendous role-playing opportunities, which is why we chose this period as the center of our Mythic Japan setting. Traditionally trained Bushi rub shoulders with European trained officers. Farmers have upended their lives to work in factories, and Geisha cross the street to avoid Steam Wagons.

You will play a member of the Society, based out of Hamamatsu Castle. The Society seeks to protect the people of Japan from supernatural threats while ensuring that the very same spirits continue to have a place of respect. Much of the ancient knowledge has been lost over the last few decades as modernization takes hold. Your library and castle represent the best record of lost traditions.

TRANSITION AND TRADITION - WHICH ARE YOU?

Vaesen is a game about change and its disruption of traditional life, with both the positive and negative effects that it can have on individuals and society at large. The rate of change that occurred in Japan was so great that you could play both traditional Bushi and modern military officers, as both existed simultaneously. Your choice of character in this setting is, in effect, not about your past - but rather about your future. Is your character one who embraces the change, seeking to protect Japan from foreign influence by copying the other nations, or one who wants to safeguard traditions from the destruction of rampant modernization? The Society, to which you belong, is seeking the middle path, the one that defends the promise of the future for the people of Japan without sacrificing all that has gone before. Archetypes developed for Mythic Japan cover both traditional and new roles in society, allowing you to play a character with a background from either.

GENDER ROLES IN JAPANESE SOCIETY

Japanese society during the Meiji period was intensely patriarchal; this was true even in comparison to the prior Tokugawa Period. The early part of the Meiji Period in particular closed down several traditional female roles - for instance, ending the existence of Onna Bugeisha (Female Bushi) and Female Shrine Maidens. Women's roles in the Meiji period were tightly defined.

"...explicitly tied to the household. A good wife is expected to be concerned with raising families of dutiful sons and daughters and ensuring the home was prosperous and harmonious." (Ryosai Kenbo - Good Wives, Wise Mothers).

Of course, this was not a universal position. Radical thinkers of the period challenged Ryosai Kenbo and her conservative views. In Mythic Japan, player characters are set apart from the broader community. Taking a leaf from the work of feminists like Hiratsuka Richo and Kageyama Hideko, players should feel free for their female characters to take any profession. A daughter secretly trained in military arts, a radical doctor who forced themselves into university, a woman of the mountains who hunts to make ends meet. In Mythic Japan, a woman may choose to embrace as her patron Amaterasu, the Goddess of the Sun, as Hiratsuka Richo did in her Famous 'New Woman Essay', taking her place as an independent force of nature.

STATUS

In Japan, so soon after the end of the Tokugawa Shogunate, status and caste are all important. A former Bushi is still going to carry themselves around with confidence and pomp, hating the formerly low-status Merchant who they are now forced to work for. So, we have added a new attribute, similar to resources but primarily intended to address your current social standing within Japanese society.

If you are high status, you will get a bonus when commanding lower status NPCs, and a minus when trying to get information (gossip etc...) from lower status people. If you are low status, you get a bonus when seeking information from people of low status, and a negative when giving orders to people above your status. Status will be created based on your upbringing, influenced by how your family fared through the restoration of imperial authority, and changed based on Profession. For example, you will start with four status if you are a Bushi, then drop two because you backed the shogun in the change, and then gained two because you became an officer in the Imperial Army after the civil war. As a result, when you try and get information from the scullery maid about the goings-on in the house, you suffer a -2 to manipulation to glean information, but you get a +2 when you order the scullery maid to seal the shutters with salt.

Status is intended to influence interaction with NPCs. The dice mechanic in particular should not be applied for PC to PC interactions. The players are members of a society with a single binding vision of a Japan resurgent that has not lost its past in the process. Players are of course welcome to role-play status and caste between characters as they see fit, however this should not be at the expense of good play and fun at the table

Status Score	Status	Command	Get Information
6-8	High Status	+1 Medium +2 Low	- 1 Medium -2 Low
3-5	Medium Status	+1 Low	-1 Low
0-2	Low Status	-2 High -1 Low	+ 2 Low



MEMENTOS

Mementos Table			
D66	Item	D66	Item
11	A dried chrysanthemum	41	Well thumbed novel
12	A photo of someone close to you	42	Plans for a family tomb
13	Buddhist prayer beads (ojuzu)	43	Map with notes on the margin
14	Your father's cane	44	Strange animal preserved in a Jar
15	A top hat (with a compartment)	45	Music box from your childhood
16	Book in Dutch	46	Jade charm
21	A Hanko (Japanese Red Seal Stamp)	51	A small bottle of perfume that reminds you of someone
22	Old love letter	52	A protective omamori (Shinto Talisman)
23	A Bonsai Tree	53	Japanese calligraphy set
24	A prized kimono	54	An unsigned will
25	Bloodstained shitagi (undershirt)	55	Golden box from a foreign land
26	Your mother's silver hairpin	56	Ukiyo-e print
31	A mahjong piece	61	A saki set
32	A classic biwa (Japanese lute)	62	An ornamental pipe
33	A Journal (yours or someone else's)	63	Aka-fukurou (Lucky owl talisman)
34	Newspaper from a date that means something to you	64	A kitsune netsuke (Pouch Toggle)
35	Ragged doll	65	A go set
36	Tame songbird	66	Emaki (handpainted scroll) handed down within the family

Male First Names				
Hideki	Yoshiaki	Yori	Nao	Sora
Tomio	Saburo	Hisao	Kunio	Toshiro
Kayo	Kunio	Toshio	Tomio	Kaneda
Tadashi	Michi	Ryuu	Taro	Akira
Nori	Hiroyuki	Hajime	Rokuro	Jurou

Female First Names				
Hoshi	Rei	Mitsuko	Nori	Haruka
Moe	Kazuko	Ayaka	Azumi	Chiyoko
Nao	Miho	Aoi	Chiasa	Kazumi
Momo	Junko	Natsumi	Amaya	Mariko
Setsuko	Ryoko	Yoko	Hiromi	Cho

Family Names				
Kawamura	Konda	Imai	Sekiguchi	Sera
Shima	Nakada	Asai	Takamoto	Kawaguchi
Miyoshi	Tengan	Kawai	Hada	Asano
Nakahara	Kawashima	Ogawa	Terada	Tomita
Ishii	Taira	Miyagawa	Fujii	Shiroma



Your Mythic Japan



Mythic Japan is set after the rise of the Emperor under the Meiji Restoration. However, like the Mythic North, it has no specific date associated with it. Mythic Japan exists in a twilight world, where the resistance to the Emperor's push to modernize continues to trouble the kingdom. In particular, to the east of the country, Japan's rural areas continue to be in semi-revolt. Simultaneously, Bushi and priests' local resistance and rejection of the Emperor's Edicts continue across the country.

The Meiji Era offers players a range of period-specific activities that occur over approximately 50 years between the founding of the Japanese constitution in 1868 and the Russian Fleet's defeat in the Straits of Tsushima in 1905. As with the Mythic North, use what you know and what you can research. Increase or decrease the available level of technology to suit your game - for instance, if you want railroads across all of Japan's major islands, then have trains everywhere. If you want the Emperor's Edict regarding the end of female leadership of Shinto temples to never happen, then just have it never occur.

LIFE IN THE CITY

Cities have been a part of Japanese Society for hundreds of years. Edo has been the heart of the Tokugawa Shogunate for the last 250 years. The Shogun's practice of having the noble families live in the city as a way of ensuring loyalty grew the city and its importance - shifting the main action away from the Daimyo's personal demesne. As cities grew in prominence, urban life, in particular the floating world (Ukiyo-e), became the center of Japanese cultural expression.

Religion is facing a sudden and rapid change - the Shinto faith is regaining preeminence as the Buddhist faith finds itself suddenly on the outer with the imperial government. Shinto, a traditionally diverse faith, is being structured around a formal belief that is best aligned with the intent of the government. Local practice is being undermined, shrine maidens are losing their authority, and Buddhist monks suddenly find themselves without wealth.

The recent push to industrialization is drawing women and children from the rural communities to modern urban cities. The government's push to modernize is driving industrialization at an unprecedented rate - protection for the workers is non-existent and recruiters travel the land promising work and pay, then not delivering on those promises. Poverty and disease spread through the poor population taking lives. Rebellion and revolt spread through the population, communism and nationalism duel for the hearts and minds of those who have no other hope.

New technologies are transforming the cities, with bicycles and steam engines becoming more prevalent. Initially from Europe, and slowly from local centers of industry, new goods are transforming the way people live their lives. Houses and living quarters of the poor are the one area that resists transition, the majority of buildings are still built in the traditional way. The first train lines have been laid down, providing a way for those who have the means to travel across the city and the country at unheralded speed.

Justice and police forces are modernizing at great speed. Until recently, torture was the accepted model for getting evidence from criminals, and summary justice was the norm. The emperor has passed edicts declaring torturers and their trade illegal, and constituting both formal judiciary and police forces. Imperial law has been formalized and is becoming the dominant force in the land, undermining the power of the Daimyos and the Bushi.

Most importantly, the urban castes of Artisans and Merchants - formally at the bottom of the social structure, suddenly find themselves gaining in preeminence. Where previously Bushi lorded it over them, they find themselves freed from such unwarranted authority. Wealth was formerly defined in Koku, literally the amount of rice a parcel of land could produce. For the first time, wealth is defined by the ability of a person to procure goods, drawing wealth from the rural areas into the cities and depriving those who traditionally had it overnight.

IMPORTANT CITIES IN MEIJI PERIOD JAPAN

Tokyo

The Imperial capital and center of power, Tokyo is a massive city with a population in excess of a million people. The trams and omnibuses provide transport throughout the city in addition the belt railway, which almost encircles the city, providing connection to outer suburbs. The quarter of Tsukiji (lit. made ground), is the residency of the large foreign population. The newly instituted Imperial University can be found in Kanda district, while the new Central Post Office takes pride of place in the central Ginza district. At the edges of the city, silk factories and new manufacturing warehouses spring up like dandelions. Each new suburb combines horrific working conditions with enclosed and densely packed accommodation. Lost Bushi and the new poor; losers from the transition can be found everywhere begging for money and food on street corners. The great park at Uneo throngs with the Nouveau Rich while criminal gangs fight for control in the red-light districts in Shinjuku. Finally, powerful local political associations patrol streets and support one or the other of the political parties active in the diet.

Kyoto

The eastern capital and former residence of the Emperor, Kyoto represents the spiritual heart of the empire. A city full of temples and monasteries, it is common for poor and rich alike to make pilgrimages to those temples. The city is slower to modernize than Tokyo and is surrounded by mountain ranges. From a size perspective, it is the third largest city in Japan, smaller than both Tokyo and Osaka, without the economic drivers that are drawing population into both larger cities. The old palace of the Emperor sits in the north Eastern Quarter of the city.

Osaka

The most significant port city and center of trade for Japan, Osaka is the second largest city in the country. The port itself throngs with foreign sailors, traders, and merchants, and the Japanese citizens who seek to trade with them. Many of the Imperial Research tours (examining trade, governance, and war in industrial countries) leave and return here. The port itself is shallow and steamers must wait outside the harbor, loading and unloading onto dedicated transports. It is now the center of a large cotton-spinning industry, and has extensive shipbuilding-yards and flourishing ironworks. The foreign residents, 122 in number, are mostly connected with missionary enterprise. Finally, the Imperial Mint operates out of Osaka providing coinage to the entire country.

Nagoya

Nagoya is an industrial center for the country, formerly the capital of Owari Province under the control of a branch of the Tokugawa Clan. Its importance to the Tokugawa is significant, as it was a base of operations under Ieyasu Tokugawa during his campaign to unify Japan. Nagoya is connected to Kyoto and Tokyo, as it lies on the Tokaido Road, which connects the Eastern and Western capitals, and was also an important pilgrimage route between them.

Nagoya is also famous for the Nagoya Castle, the center of operations for the “People of the Third Eye”. Nagoya is connected to the sea through its port and is also on the train line that follows the Tokaido. Nagoya has a population of 186,000 and produces cotton, silk, and porcelain for foreign trade and local consumption.

The Tokaido

The Tokaido was the most important land trade route on the main island of Honshu. It connects the largest and most important cities. The push by the imperial government to modernize and the decision to shift the imperial capital to Tokyo resulted in a shift in power between the Eastern and Western Capitals. A train line now runs along the old Tokaido connecting the critical ports of Osaka and Kobe with Tokyo. A number of other cities and towns can be found along the route.



Miles from Tokyo	Name of Town	Population	Notes
18	Yokohama	143,754	Tokyo major port
55	Odawara	22,000	Ancient seat of Government, thirteenth century.
70	Miyanoshita	4,000	Natural sulfur springs
72	Hakone	3,000	Mountain Pass 3,500 feet Above sea level.
75	Atami	3,000	Natural springs. Sea bathing
80	Mishima	15,000	Nothing of note
120	Shidzuoka	36,343	Seat of former Shogun
167	Hamamatsu	25,000	Extensive general trade.
191	Toyohashi or Yoshida	18,000	Large junk trade.
209	Okazaki	21,000	Crape and cotton goods.
233	Nagoya	185,776	Pottery, silk, and general large trade.
252	Gifu	32,406	Crape and silk fabrics.
287	Hikone	17,000	Old Castle Town.
318	Otsu	31,279	Mart for lake-borne merchandise.
330	Kyoto	308,266	Porcelain, lacquer, and other specialties. Former seat of Imperial Government.
352	Osaka	479,546	The Manchester of Japan. Greatest trade.
376	Kobe	148,625	Foreign Treaty Port, with Extensive trade.

COMMUNICATION AND TRAVEL

Until recently, the only way to pass a message from one place to another was through runners or horse riders. This system of couriers operated across the country, linking the various provinces together. Messages took a long time to traverse the mountainous and complex terrain, and was hazardous. The introduction of the telegraph and railroads changed this by providing an infrastructure that could communicate in near real time between telegraph offices, and provide rail transport that could deliver mail, goods and people to their destination more quickly and safely than ever before.

Postal Service

Hisoka Maejima, appointed the Superintendent of Postal Services, hired an American expert, Samuel Bryson, to assist in the development of a national postal service. In 1872 the old privately organized courier system was discarded and a new national service, based largely on the British model, was adopted. The success of the new service was greatly assisted by the parallel development of an extensive railway system that provided access to the outer provinces. Postage stamps were introduced and postal rates became uniform throughout the country. Progress in Japan's postal system also led to a rationalization of weights and measures, making Japanese products measurable to other countries. By 1877, the postal service was sufficiently advanced that it was able to join the Universal Postal Union, therefore linking Japan with the rest of the world.

The Japanese delighted in sending each other mail, as communications between the major cities and the provinces became possible. Around 1880, picture postcards became extremely popular in Japan, and it became a custom to send them to friends and family for New Year's. By 1895 there were over 3700 post offices and 34000 mailboxes operating in Japan.

Telephone

Telephones were first introduced to Japan in 1877, when Alexander Graham Bell personally visited Japan to demonstrate the apparatus. The first telephones were found in governmental ministries and several Tokyo police stations, however the service suffered from many complications and poor reception. In 1890, the government implemented a national corporation, and the improved system was extended to many post offices where private citizens were able to make calls. Telephones are not available in most homes until after the end of the Meiji Period (1905).

Telegraph

Following the Meiji Restoration of 1868, Japan constructed the first telegraph line between Tokyo and Yokohama in 1869, hiring a British telegraph engineer and a Danish cable company for the project.

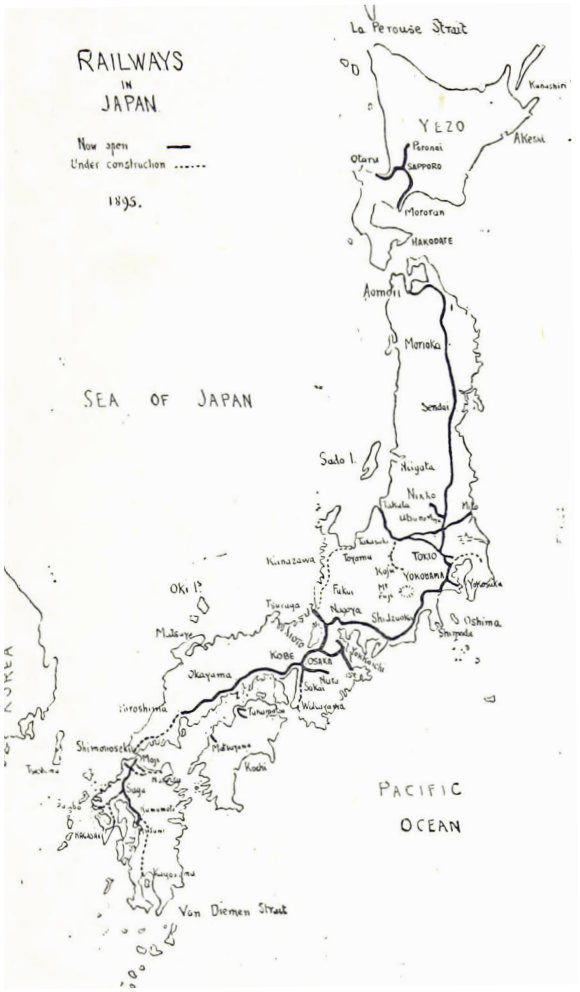
By 1872, Japan was served by direct telegraphic communication with Europe. During the next two decades, the Japanese telegraph network expanded rapidly. By 1891, Japan had over 400 telegraph offices connected by nearly 12,000 km of wire.

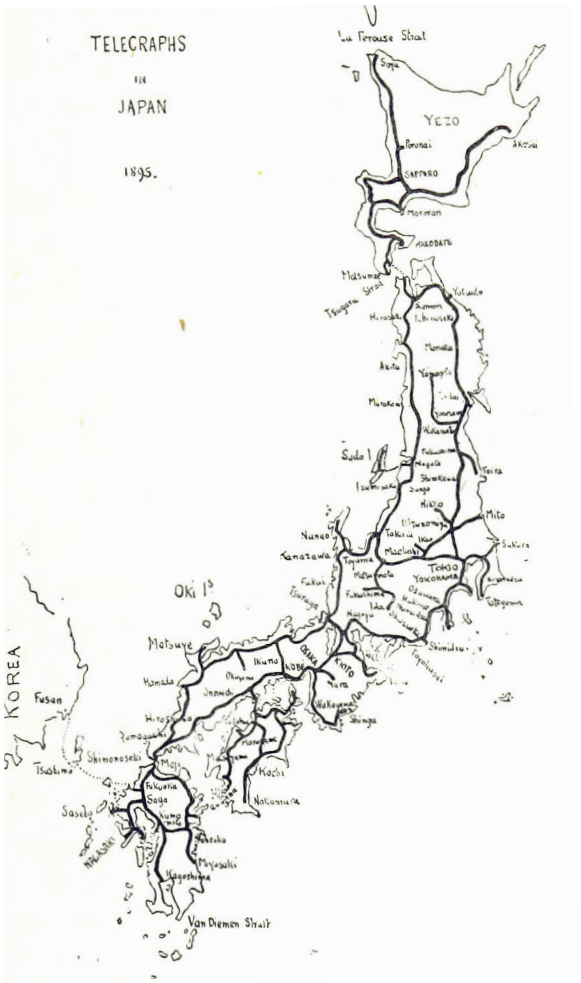
Transport

Japan's first railway line ran from Tokyo to Yokohama; from Shinbashi to Sakuragicho stations. Survey work for the line began in 1870, and the line was officially opened on 14 October 1872. It enabled a journey of 29 km to be covered in 53 minutes.

After the completion of the first line, railways started springing up across the country. In 1874, regular service began between Osaka and Kobe, extending to Kyoto in 1876. In 1883, the first private service began between Ueno in Tokyo and Kumagaya, extended all the way to Aomori northern Honshu by 1891.

Trains in particular are a physical representation of industrial change flowing through Japan. People are confronted by these giant, noisy, fast-moving steam engines, and the engineering work on the lines that enable them. They connect cities and allow transport of people and goods at breakneck speed. They have as yet not reached into the mountainous heart of Japan, the cost and complexity of making the lines reach that far have defeated even the most ambitious engineers. As a result, travel into the rural areas is often comprised of at least two steps - train travel to the nearest city, and then either carriage or horse to the village or town in the regional rural areas.


RAILWAYS
IN
JAPAN
Now open
Under construction
1895.
La Perouse Strait
YEZO
Otaru
Sapporo
Hakodate
Aomori
Morioka
Sendai
Sado I.
Niigata
Tokio
Yokohama
Yokosuka
Oshima
Shimoda
Kanazawa
Toyama
Fukui
Nagoya
Shizuoka
Oki Is
Matsuye
Okayama
Kobe
Osaka
Hiroshima
Shimonoseki
Fukuoka
Saga
Nagasaki
Kochi
Tokushima
Wakayama
SEA OF JAPAN
PACIFIC
OCEAN
Van Diemen Strait


TELEGRAPHS
IN
JAPAN
1895.
La Perouse Strait
YEZO
Sapporo
Hakodate
Aomori
Sado I.
Tokio
Yokohama
Nagoya
Kobe
Osaka
Oki Is
Matsuye
Fusan
KOREA
Shimonoseki
Fukuoka
Saga
Kochi
Van Diemen Strait

Daisan no me no taisei (The Society of the Third Eye)



Greetings to you, the first Daisan no Me to be born in a generation. My name is Katsushika □i, and I am the last daughter of the Hokusai and holder of the history of our order. I reach out to you because our country is broken. We have lost our way and the Yokai are rising from their peaceful state. Spirits haunt the roads again; children are lost in the rivers, and we have no answers to the questions that they ask.

We were the first, and we will be the last; our passage shall quell the Demons and the Spirits, for we are the bringers of peace.

THE FIRST SCHOLAR

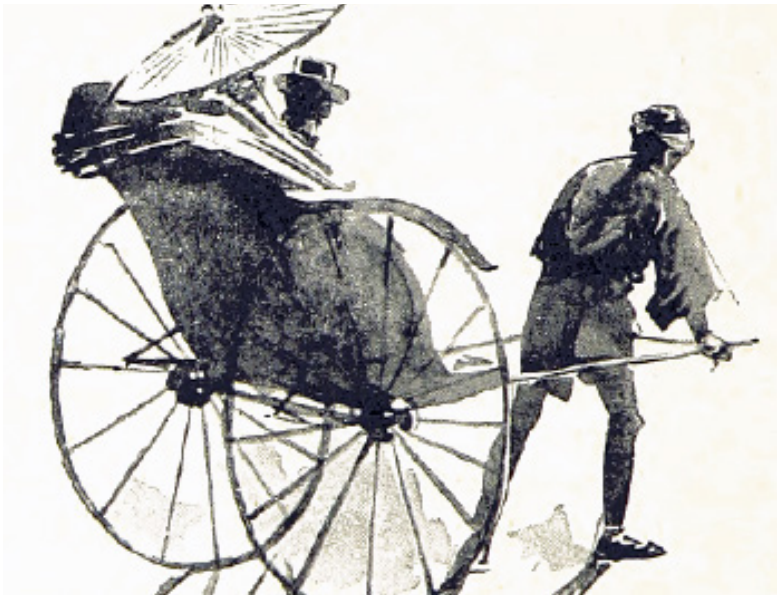
There was a child born a thousand years ago, her mother was the first wife of the Genji, Aoi no Ue. She is the hidden daughter, born while her mother suffered at the hands of the angry spirits. The Lady was the founder and mother of our order. Know this - our lady has no name, for when she was born during the Heian Period, no person of noble birth would have been so uncouth as to tell others their name, so we simply know her as the Lady of Hidden Eyes (me ga kakureteru hime).

The Lady spent the first decade of her life hidden from the world, living in seclusion after the death of her mother, Aoi. She was tended by her nurse and a Miko (shrine maiden). Even as a young child, she was gifted. An exemplar of proper noble bearing, she was unusually kind and diffident to all. Her childhood was also full of wonder, surrounded by the Hi-ningenteki na ikemono who populated the surrounds of her home. Her fortunes changed dramatically upon the ascension of her brother to the Imperial Throne. She was brought to court, serving as a junior lady in waiting for a concubine of the Emperor.

One night, her brother the Emperor, was struck down by a curse placed on him by an Inugami - a dog spirit created to serve evil sorcerers. The lady was able to see the spirit and talk to it, allowing her to identify the source of the curse. Members of the Fujiwara clan, advisors to the Emperor, listened as the Lady described the creature in some detail. Unsure what to do but suspicious of this girl child, the Fujiwara considered locking her away. Luckily, the lady had a plan - persuading the court of her good intentions was difficult, but once she described her plan, they were willing to see it to completion. The lady followed the trail of the Inugami to the house of the actual sorcerer, a distant relative of the Emperor who felt slighted. Locating the bones of the dog spirit was easy, and then she used them to place a curse on the family of the sorcerer. Desperate to escape the curse, the wife of the sorcerer raced to the location of the bones and began to dig up the skeleton. The Lady stepped from the darkness, surrounded by Fujiwara retainers, and captured the sorcerer and his family. The sorcerer was forced to destroy the bones, and the curse was lifted from the Emperor.

The Lady was rewarded, becoming a trusted member of the court; soon all valued her gifts. However, this placed her in direct conflict with the Fujiwara Clan as they sought to regain authority within the court. The Emperor, the Lady, and the leader of the Fujiwara, realizing how this would likely end, agreed to a compromise. The Lady would be tasked with creating the first inventory of Hi-ningenteki na ikemono, cataloging the Yokai, Yurei, and Oni of Japan. To aid her in this mission, she was given an imperial mandate to seek out those like herself, born with the third eye, recruiting them into the Emperor's service. The Lady created the first catalogue of creatures. In addition, her followers went on to stop the depredations of evil sorcerers, Oni, and mischievous Yokai.

The fall of the Fujiwara led to the first collapse in support of the Society - we were forgotten and went into hiding. Our work continued throughout the many imperial reigns - working from the shadows, we sought to protect the people of Japan from creatures of the night. We would rise again, through the work of the second scholar.



THE SECOND SCHOLAR

After the founding of the Tokugawa Shogunate, we waited, watching for evidence of change, afraid of what might follow. We sought to protect our people from creatures and foreign threats. We made our presence known to Tokugawa Iemitsu, the third shogun and descendant of Ieyasu, and unveiled for the first time in 500 years our imperial mandate. We believed that Iemitsu was ready to protect our country and people from the foreign powers. While we did not write it, our influence was felt in the writing of the Sakoku Edict, setting in place an order of things that mirrored what we saw in the world around us. Our place was once again assured. No one would threaten the order of things, and we would ensure that balance was maintained between the mortal and supernatural worlds.

Our second great scholar, Toyofusa Sano known as Toriyama Sekien, was born in the imperial era of Shōtoku, and was from birth a gifted scholar, but also one who challenged all that he saw. He saw his first creature at the age of seven, a grieving spirit seeking to lure children to their deaths at the riverside. His mother was one of us, knowledgeable and wise. She fought the Yurei to a standstill, long enough for Sekien to escape its clutches and flee. Sekien's mother did not escape. Her body was found down river from where he was attacked. Sekien's memory of that day was forever burned into his mind - his sight changed, he had become one of our people, the People of the Third Eye.

Sekien had a drive to understand that was unmatched among our society, driven to return us to our original task. He spent his time traveling the land, collecting tales of Hi-ningenteki and mortal encounters with them - he also conversed with many of the creatures himself. He leveraged the earlier work of the lady, confirming and noting where behaviors of the Hi-ningenteki had changed. It was this point that he tried to drive home to us, one that in hindsight we should have paid far greater attention to. Despite what we had believed, the Hi-ningenteki did change, their behaviors and actions were alterable, although why they changed - and how - has never been understood.

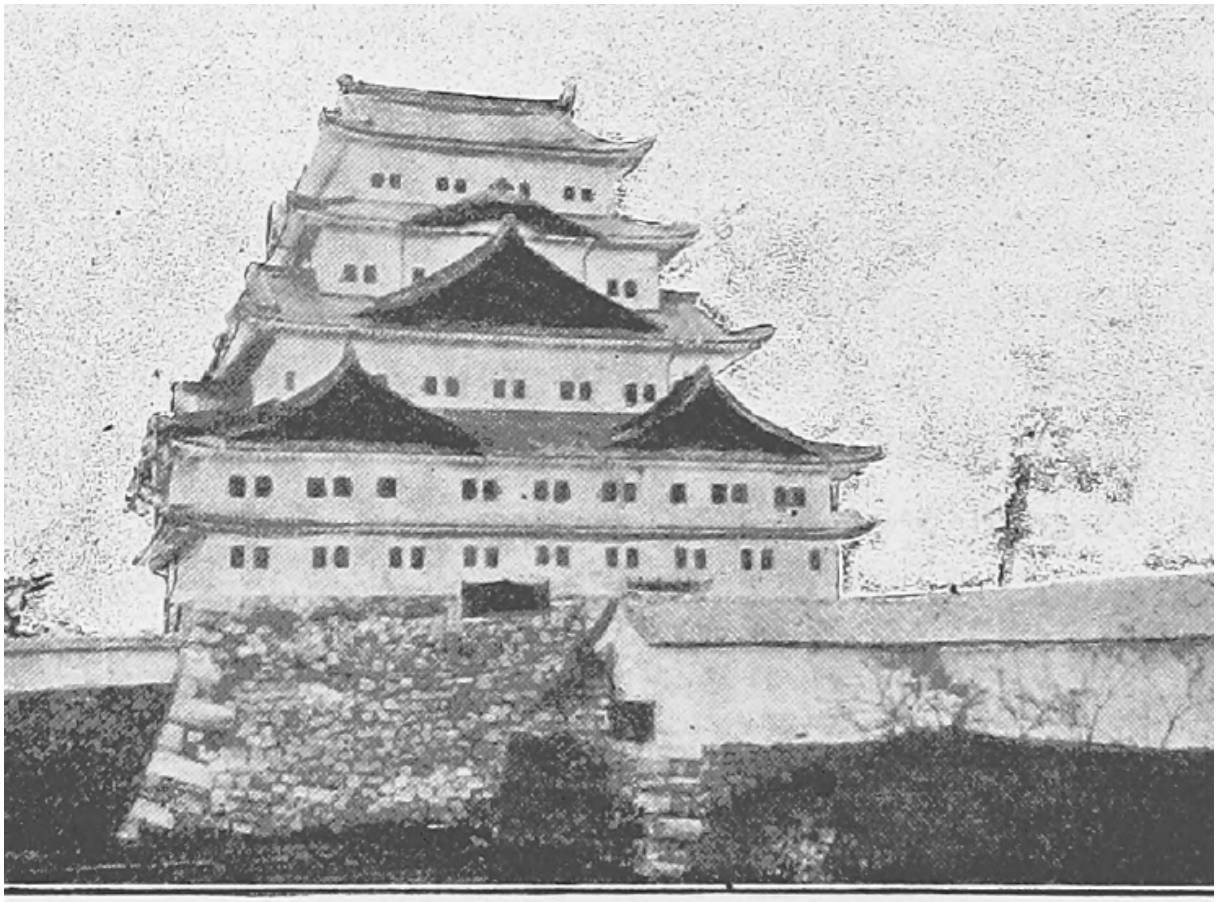
The work of Seiken took many years to collate, but was highly valued by our order and the Daimyo whose castle we now resided within. Sekien held a belief that the best way to protect the populace was to give them access to our knowledge. Our council and the Daimyo disagreed - Sekien never one to just agree decided to leave the order, taking his experience with him. Sekien split the order in two, a small group of his followers went with him, helping him publish a copy of his work. Of course, we could not allow this to stand unpunished - an Inugami was summoned and sent after him and his followers. We were unable to stop him publishing his work, but he died soon after, the truth of his knowledge lost to us and his followers.

THE THIRD SCHOLAR

The last of our great scholars and the one who oversaw the end of our order, known to the world as Katsushika Hokusai, was the greatest of the Ukiyo-e artists. Hokusai spent his extended life documenting all that he saw and practicing his Art. He was the leader of our society for many years, living a long and fruitful life. However, while his art grew in prominence and importance, the society had begun to struggle. The Shogunate had provided for our support through the allocation of a stipend tied to farmers working within the Owari Province. This stipend could no longer support the society as the costs grew and the stipend stayed frozen. Our ability to continue to protect the people of Japan was also being restricted, impacted by the official censor and the growing distrust of the Shogunate. The Tenpo Reforms, which banned many forms of Ukiyo-e, had a quelling effect on our society - stripping it of our critical source of income.

While we had been focused on making money and working with the Ukiyo-e artist schools, we had become distracted. For reasons that we do not understand, children born with the Third Eye had become rare. Our country was already changing, the Tokugawa had demanded that Daimyo and their families spent time in Edo, and the tradition and culture of our people were under threat. Merchants and Artisans rose to prominence, even as Bushi and farmers starved. Our society was fading, many of our members could no longer see the spirits - rather they were selected for their artistic skill or the lesser sons of Bushi, desperate to get access to our stipend, little though it was. Hokusai was disgusted by these lesser lights. He foresaw our collapse as we lost sight of why we existed and what we were meant to do.

Hokusai washed his hands of our order, leaving us in the year 1831. His final gift to us, and his warning to the last of us, was given to us through his greatest work. A wave is coming, something powerful is waiting to arise, and it will change our order, our country, and our people. We do not know what the force that Hokusai saw coming is, but even now it is drawing closer.



THE END AND NEW BEGINNINGS

Without Hokusai, we faded. There was no dramatic moment in our end, rather we simply ceased to be relevant. Inflation and nepotism combined to bring an end to our order - it was not the Hi-ningenteki that brought us undone. We could no longer afford to support our work, and even if we had, we had ceased to be Daisan no Me. There were no new children born with the gift, or at least none that we could find. The few aging members of our society with the Third Eye fought to keep our society focused on our mission. Their efforts were in vain, as the order no longer had a purpose. The final nail in our coffin was the Restoration. Our stipend was ended by order of the Emperor. No longer able to support our members, the order collapsed.

Katsushinka Ōi is an old woman, having survived the collapse of the order and as far as she is aware - the last of the Daisan no Me. She does not know why the order failed to locate any more Daisan no Me but is excited by the thought of new blood coming into the society. She is elderly and has little to provide the new members of the society. She now has an inkling of the threats that her father was warning her about. She realizes that the boats in The Great Wave of Kanagawa represent the order in some form. Although why there are three boats is unclear.

The possible reasons for connecting to Katsushinka Ōi is up to the GM. The following are options based on the existing suggestions in the core rule book:

- The Hi-ningenteki are changing in their behavior and are suddenly restive, out of concern of what is happening and the apparent threat this represents to people of Japan, she has reached out to the players. A servant spirit appears to the characters, demanding their attendance.
- • The players have been seeing Hi-ningenteki and are looking for sources of information. They realize that the work of members of the Ukiyo-e schools has captured actual sightings of the Hi-ningenteki. Research indicates that Ōi may be the last to know what is going on, as the descendant of Hokusai.
- A Hi-ningenteki attacks one of the party members. Ōi intervenes, driving the creature away, but makes it clear to the player that she is too old to continue the fight. She is, however, capable of finding others who may be able to help the player finally resolve the threat that the creatures pose.
- Katsushinka Ōi appears in the dreams of players, whispering warnings to all of them. They feel an irresistible pull towards the castle at Nagoya when the players arrive at the castle, they find the woman of their dreams pulled them to the same location.

Who is Katsushinka Ōi?

Katsushinka Ōi is a real historical figure, an accomplished Ukiyo-e artist in her own right and a daughter of the most famous Ukiyo-e artist, Hokusai. She created many prints related to the depiction of beautiful women, making an impact on the society of Tokugawa Japan. Little is known of her personal life, beyond the fact that she lived almost to the end of the Tokugawa Period.

Archetypes



ACADEMIC

My father was a wealthy merchant, like his father before him, stretching back many generations. I was born in Nagasaki, where my family made a fortune trading with foreigners who would bring spices, cloth, and new technology into the port city. My father was fluent in Chinese, and even knew some Dutch and Portuguese, which he taught me. I always wanted to know about their lives and the world beyond the horizon. So I begged my father to let me study at Keio University in Tokyo, and to my joy, he agreed - my time studying at Keio was a dream. I was handpicked by my professors to accompany a team of scholars and politicians led by Ito Hirobumi, a London educated Bushi, to study the foreigner's constitutions, so we may better formulate our own upon returning. One day in Prussia, while touring the palace of Wilhelm II, In the back of the great hall, I noticed a barrel rolling across the floor, followed by a dozen small men carrying papers and books. While I stood there counting them, I noticed none of my compatriots seemed to see them. But they noticed me, and punished me for my lack of respect.



Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

PROFESSIONS

- Teacher of 'Dutch Learning'
- Professor working at Tokyo University
- Researcher into Foreign Laws

MOTIVATION

- To study and travel the world
- To understand the foreigner's tongue
- Becoming a famous politician

TRAUMA

- I was almost drowned by a Kapa (turtle spirit)
- My daughter was eaten by a Gashadokuro (starving skeleton)
- I am visited every night by a Yurie who watches me sleep

DARK SECRET

- I gambled my family's money away
- I plagiarized the works of one of my peers
- I am addicted to Chinese opium

RELATIONSHIPS

Choose a relationship for each of the other player characters, or make up your own

- A tool for my purposes
- I cannot stay calm in your presence.
- A good friend

- Main Attribute: Logic
- Main Skill: Learning
- Status: 4
- Talents: Bookworm, Erudite, Knowledge is Reassuring
- Resources: 4-6
- Equipment: Book collection or map book, writing utensils, liquor or slide rule.

WARRIOR

I was born in the Province of Shimosa and was raised as the loyal daughter of a noble family. When our Daimyo called us to battle, I arrived younger than others, but trained in the arts of war. Like many of my kin I was not just a warrior, but a poet and an artist. At the battle of Ueno, none of this mattered. Our lines were shattered by gunfire and cannon - I awoke on the battlefield the next day, badly injured, having been struck down by rifle fire in the midst of battle. It was then that I saw them, Tengu grieving at the loss of so many swordsmen. Their black shapes stalked the field, one found me and nursed me back to health - a final act of mercy from the great teachers of the sword. When I returned to my home, five years had passed and I discovered I am no longer allowed to be Bushi, my swords and top knot made illegal in a world gone mad. I do not understand this new world and why the Tengu kept me away for so long, but I fear I have no place in it.



Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

PROFESSIONS

- Onna Bugeshia
- Samurai
- Ronin

MOTIVATION

- Protect traditions of the past
- Find a place in this new world
- Find the perfect death, one that honors my ancestors

TRAUMA

- Was attacked by an Oni, who killed my best friend
- Wife died in childbirth and rose as an Ubume (pregnant ghost)
- Fought a duel against a wandering boshi, who turned out to be a Tengu (crow warrior) in disguise

DARK SECRET

- I am a coward
- I punished lower castes, beheading a defenseless child
- I am the son of a merchant, my identity is a lie

RELATIONSHIPS

Choose a relationship for each of the other player characters, or make up your own

- You are less worthy than me
- Bushido (code of honor) demands that I protect you
- I wish I could be like you

- Main Attribute: Physique
- Main Skill: Close Combat
- Status: 6
- Talents: Sword Drawing Technique, Mastery of both Pen and Sword, Righteousness
- Resources: 2-5
- Equipment: Daisho, Yumi or Tanagashima Musket, Calligraphy Set, Medium Armour

CRIMINAL

I am a Tekiya, a conveyor of useful things. I have found lost things in hidden places or have been given items whose providence is at best unknown. Many of these things come with a cost or a history that you would prefer not to know. My family has done this for generations, we are the ones that others richer and wealthier turn to satisfy unacceptable urges. I believe in this new world, many of my family suddenly find we have value to the new regime, in a world where you cannot simply behead a dissident in the street. A more remote application of force is now needed by those who are in power and we are the ones who can supply it. One of the items we have come into ownership of, a copper coloured teapot, is odd. Everyone agrees it makes the very best tea. However, I can't shake the feeling that the pot is watching me - sometimes in the right light, I see the shadow of something else, in place of the teapot.



Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

PROFESSIONS

- Tekiya (Peddler of stolen goods)
- Bakuto (Gambling gang member)
- Kabuki-mono (Bandit)

MOTIVATION

- Protect this new world
- Improve my station
- Make my way in the world

TRAUMA

- Something I stole has come alive
- A priest has sent a spirit servant to punish me
- A Gaki (hungry ghost) haunts me

DARK SECRET

- I stole from a temple and am now cursed
- I am the son of a boshi, who fell into poverty
- I am wanted for a terrible crime and must conceal my identity

RELATIONSHIPS

Choose a relationship for each of the other player characters, or make up your own

- I wonder what you really want
- I'll help you survive this new world
- You seem nice, perhaps too nice

- Main Attribute: Physique
- Main Skill: Manipulation
- Status: 1
- Talents: Tough as Nails, Suspicious, Well Traveled
- Resources: 1 - 6
- Equipment: Knife, Lockpicks or a Pistol, Lamp, Disguise kit

DOCTOR

My father was a practitioner of traditional medicine famous for his treatment of the last of the Tokugawa, while they still ruled our country. His death at the battle of Ueno still haunts me, as I can feel his presence whenever I look in a mirror. My own path was informed and driven by the great innovator Fukuzawa Yukichi, his Institute for Infectious Diseases was where I learned my trade. I have seen men saved from diseases that would have killed them ten years ago. I have forgone the skills of my father, for not only did they fail him on the battlefield, but clearly they were different than those that the Europeans possess. I fear however this decision has not gone unnoticed. Whenever I am alone I see my father, his haggard face reflected in the mirrors of my house, the sake in my cup and sometimes in my bath as I rest. I am afraid he has become angered by my decision and will seek revenge before this day is out.



Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

PROFESSIONS

- Surgeon
- Traditional Practitioner
- Doctor

MOTIVATION

- Aiding the weak and the afflicted
- Learning that which was lost
- Exploring and describing the world

TRAUMA

- I am haunted by an Onryo (vengeful spirit)
- A corpse came to life while I examined it
- Was tricked by a Sazae Oni (snail demon)

DARK SECRET

- I lied to get into university
- I am involved in illicit affairs
- I have an unnatural Lust

RELATIONSHIPS

Choose a relationship for each of the other player characters, or make up your own

- I trust you with my secrets
- You annoy me
- I dream of you at night

- Main Attribute: Logic
- Main Skill: Medicine
- Status: 5
- Talents: Army Medic, Chief Physician, Emergency Medicine
- Resources: 4 - 6
- Equipment: Doctor's Bag with medical equipment, Sake, Rickshaw driver or a strong poison

ENTERTAINER

The floating world was the place where Bushi fled when the demands of honor and tradition overwhelmed them. I was one of those who inhabited that world, and through my art, I gave them a refuge from the needs of their families and lords. In my presence, they could act in accordance with their natures. Simultaneously they shunned me outside of the teahouse - I was ignored by them and treated like a piece of rubbish. Thanks to the Emperor's Edicts, I can practice my art wherever I want, I play my instruments and sing songs to be heard by all. One night I was woken by a cat, of incredible height and girth, he insisted that I come with him to play music at the wedding of the Prince of Cats and his betrothed. That was a magical night, the food flowed freely, and at the end of the night, I was paid most handsomely for my time and gifted this beautiful Shamisen. I wish they would come again and ask to play just one more time.



Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

PROFESSIONS

- Geisha (female performer)
- Noh Performer (musical theatre)
- Musician

MOTIVATION

- Be the best in my art.
- Make my friends happy, even in the darkest of times.
- Find an audience that really appreciates my art

TRAUMA

- I was kidnapped and forced to play for a spirit court.
- My musical instrument came alive in my hands and sang the most beautiful song to me.
- I have seen Gaki (hungry ghost) rise up to haunt a family

DARK SECRET

- I am on the run from Bakuto (Gambling Gang), who I owe money too
- I long to join a Spirit Court.
- I was once an assassin.

RELATIONSHIPS

Choose a relationship for each of the other player characters, or make up your own

- I love playing for you
- Can I be your friend
- Let's hope we continue as we began

- Main Attribute: Empathy
- Main Skill: Inspiration
- Status: 2
- Talents: Seductive, Defensive, Inspired
- Resources: 2-4
- Equipment: Musical Instrument or dancing fans, Makeup kit, Knife or handgun, a memento from an admirer

HUNTER

My father and I were trapped in the forest as a sudden blizzard stuck. Hiding in a decrepit cabin for the night with no fire, I was afraid neither of us would survive. I was startled awake by the door being blown open by what I thought was the wind. Then I saw her, a beautiful woman, pale and white, standing over my father. Her breath washed over him, coating him in frost. She turned toward me and stopped. For some reason, she did not do the same to me. A year later, I met a beautiful woman on the side of the road. We have beautiful children, but there is something haunting about her, and I cannot tell what. Many others in Nippon feel the pull of change as the Emperor's edicts set the world on fire. But here in the Mountains, we see none of this. The trees still grow, boars still run, and badger pelts are always treasured.



Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

PROFESSIONS

- Hunter
- Explorer
- Forest Logger

MOTIVATION

- The thing that attacked my family must be destroyed
- Live in tune with nature
- Locate the heart of the forest

TRAUMA

- I saw a Yuki-No-Onna (snow woman) kill my father; her breath still chills me
- I became lost in the forest and was guided home by a Kitsune (fox wife)
- I lost my manhood to a Sazae Oni (snail demon)

DARK SECRET

- I cannot control my fits of rage
- I have children with a Yokai
- I betrayed a confidence an Onryo (Grudge Spirit) pursues me

RELATIONSHIPS

Choose a relationship for each of the other player characters, or make up your own

- I am ready to serve
- I hate arrogant people like you
- You're a townie weakling

- Main Attribute: Precision
- Main Skill: Ranged Combat
- Status: 3
- Talents: Bloodhound, Herbalist, Marksman
- Resources: 2-4
- Equipment: Rifle, Hunting knife, or hunting dog. Traps or hunting equipment

POLICE

I look outside my window every morning, and I still find it hard to believe where I find myself in life. The air of the city continues to become ever more polluted with each new refinery and factory built in Tokyo. However, from the Imperial Palace of Kyoto, the fresh gales of change are sweeping across the nation, and into the city. My father was an Okabiki, a criminal granted forgiveness for the price of being a dog to the Doshin, the Bushi Police. When I was a child, he would spend long hours day and night, lurking in the shadows as an informant, a spy, a private detective for the Doshin. With the changes of laws following the Emperor′s rise into power, I was absolved from my family′s caste, and with a chance at becoming something my father could never even possibly have imagined. A few months back while tracking down the location of a Bushi, who in a drunken rage struck down an innkeeper and his wife, I happened upon something I could not possibly have imagined. I tracked the man to a Ryokan (roadside inn), empty of people except for a large folded up futon lying on the opposite end of the room′s tatami mat. The man was drained of fat, and his mouth stuck open in a ghastly expression of a scream. From head to toe, he was wrapped in thick sticky silk. I turned around at the sound of movement from the tree-line, and I will never forget the glow of those eight yellow orbs staring back at me.



Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

PROFESSIONS

- Police Officer
- Spy
- Lawyer

MOTIVATION

- Bring law and order back to the country
- The thrill of solving the unsolvable
- Protecting and adhering to the Emperor's constitution

TRAUMA

- I saw a Jurogumo (spider woman) while investigating a murder
- I caught a Tanuki (racoon shape-shifter) in a theatre
- My brother was drowned by a Bancho Sarayashiki (well ghost)

DARK SECRET

- Your service pistol misfired and maimed a child
- You are not faithful to your wife, and frequently visit the red light districts of Tokyo
- You once falsely accused a man of a crime, but were too afraid to admit your mistake and he was executed

RELATIONSHIPS

Choose a relationship for each of the other player characters, or make up your own

- I think I can trust you
- A good person
- Tries to understand you

- Main Attribute: Logic
- Main Skill: Investigation
- Status: 5
- Talents: Eagle Eye, Elementary, Focused
- Resources: 2-5
- Equipment: Magnifying glass or a lockpick, Revolver, Handcuffs, and Badge.

SHRINE MAIDEN / SHAMAN

I am an Itako, born blind to the world of men, but gifted with the ability to see Kami and the rest of the spirit world. I trained from birth, repeatedly bathing in frozen mountain streams and walking barefoot through the snow. I learned the rituals and songs of our tradition and prepared myself for marriage to a Kami, committed to a long life of service. People would come to me to speak to their loved ones once my marriage was complete. On the day of my marriage, the edict banning superstitious activities was passed in the Emperors' name. My wedding was not completed as the police stormed the ceremony. Just as the handcuffs were placed on my arms, my husband roused himself from his slumber at the bottom of the lake. He reached out his arms and drowned the police, the guests, and the passersby. I am the only survivor - what I do has been called illegal by the Emperor's advisors, but if I stay silent, who will connect the living and the dead?



Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

PROFESSIONS

- Itako (blind oracle)
- Fujo (shaman)
- Miko (shrine maiden)

MOTIVATION

- Connect the living and the dead
- Help people make peace with themselves
- Find an apprentice who I can be train to follow my tradition

TRAUMA

- I saw a Yuki Onna (Snow Woman) while I undertook my initiation rituals
- My family was killed by an angry Yurei who I had failed.
- A Goze no Yurei (blind musician ghost) stole my eyes

DARK SECRET

- I am a fraud
- My husband demands a Hitobashira (human sacrifice)
- I cannot control my powers

RELATIONSHIPS

Choose a relationship for each of the other player characters, or make up your own

- You are hiding something from the rest of us
- You bring me peace
- You will save us all one day

- Main Attribute: Empathy
- Main Skill: Observation
- Status: 4
- Talents: Use all your senses, Kuchiyose, Tamayori Hime
- Resources: 1-4
- Equipment: Spirit box, Certificate of training, Katana, Mirror, White or Red clothing

OFFICER

I was there the day the fool Satsuma tried to rebel against the Emperor's vision. The world is changing, and Nippon can no longer afford to isolate herself from the rest of the world and be left behind, weak. To be taken advantage of by the barbarous foreigners who come evermore to our shores... no... The Emperor has a vision for our country, and Satsuma is but a stubborn mule standing on the train tracks of progress. Before me, thousands lay dead under a moonlit sky. I sent my scouts out to locate the direction of the remaining rebel forces that had fled into the night, when gunshots began to ring out, followed by yells and screams. As fast as I could, I rode my horse down to the edge of the field, and it was there that I saw what my men were shooting at. I stood in shock as a giant skeletal parody of a man lifted up one of my scouts and brought his mouth down upon the poor soul, severing his head from his shoulders. It took all night until I could finally get an accurate artillery strike on the thing that continues to haunt my dreams still.



Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

PROFESSIONS

- Imperial Army Officer
- Naval Commander
- Imperial Army Soldier

MOTIVATION

- Make my family proud
- The Emperor and my country need me
- To seek out danger and death

TRAUMA

- I saw a Shikigami (summoned spirit) collecting the souls of my men on the battlefield.
- Lost all your men to a vengeful Gashadokuro (starving skeleton).
- An Omukade (centipede demon) killed my horse and almost myself with it.

DARK SECRET

- I am a deserter
- I am afraid of battle
- I killed a defenseless enemy

RELATIONSHIPS

Choose a relationship for each of the other player characters, or make up your own

- Protects you at any cost
- Distrusts you
- My leader

- Main Attribute: Precision
- Main Skill: Ranged Combat
- Status: 7
- Talents: Battle-hardened, Gentleman, Tactician
- Resources: 3-7
- Equipment: Rifle or Pistol, Compass or Bayonet, Map Book or Saber

PRIEST

When I started my training as a Kannushi, I knew what was expected of me. Our temple was wealthy and respected, my family has provided Kannushi (shrine priest) to the temple for the last thousand years. I was the oldest daughter of my family and I was proud to be the one who would lead our temple. Then the edict was pronounced, women were no longer to serve as priests of any temple, by the order of his imperial majesty. My grief was as all-encompassing as was my rage - I cried to the heavens at the injustice of it all and a voice answered. Izanami-no-Mikoto had heard my rage and like me had been cheated out of her respect by a man. Even as I cried out, Izanami offered a way back, for a small price I could continue to be the priest of my temple. I screamed yes and my little brother was seized by her Shikome (or Oni women). The emperor's edict has no effect on me, for Izanami has ensured that I am beyond its reach, for I am transformed. But my brother is gone and I am not sure it is a price worth paying.



Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

PROFESSIONS

- Shrine Priest
- Monk
- Hermit

MOTIVATION

- Please the Kami and continue the traditions
- Ensure the purity of myself and others
- Respect the Emperor, find a way to balance the new and the old

TRAUMA

- A Kami has transformed me, rendering me changed from how I was born.
- Sought and failed to appease a Yurei
- Was tricked by a Tananuki (raccoon shape-shifter) which stole the temple bell

DARK SECRET

- I stole from the temple, living in luxury on the stolen proceeds
- An Oni has corrupted me
- I no longer believe the Kami are our protectors

RELATIONSHIPS

Choose a relationship for each of the other player characters, or make up your own

- My disciple
- I am purer than you
- Secretly in love with you

- Main Attribute: Empathy
- Main Skill: Observation
- Status: 7
- Talents: Absolution, Blessing, Confessor
- Resources: 4-6
- Equipment: Musical Instrument or temple bell, Writing kit, blessed item, holy scroll

SERVANT

My name is Matsumoto, and I am a child of Eta parents. I grew up separate from all others, one of the polluted. My parents worked as torturers, extracting the truth from criminals to ensure that the emperor's laws were enforced. For this, we were treated as untouchables and excluded from all other activities. At least our lives had meaning; we were the ones the Bushi police called upon when a criminal would not talk. Now the Emperor has outlawed torture and freed us from our caste. This freedom from persecution the Emperor gave us has only resulted in our descent. My mother died three years ago today, begging for food. No one would look at her, they all remember who she had been and what she continued to be in their eyes. Once she was dead, we buried her in a pauper's grave, but she did not stay there. She followed us to our home, a Gaki (hungry ghost). I have seen her - I steal food from my masters, who will never miss it, to alleviate her hunger. I am afraid of what will happen if I forget to place the offerings. My masters have children, and I have seen how she looks at them - like they are a meal to be eaten.



Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

PROFESSIONS

- Butler
- Chef
- Gardener

MOTIVATION

- Protect those who I serve
- Advance myself, taking advantage of the Emperor's edicts
- An urge to help both humans and Ukiyo

TRAUMA

- My mother is a Gaki (hungry ghost), and I must appease her hunger.
- I once laid with a Kitsune (fox wife), now I look for her everywhere.
- My old master was corrupted and returned as an Oni.

DARK SECRET

- I am Hinin, untouchable if my master finds out, they may fire me
- I am a thief
- I work for the Europeans as a spy.

RELATIONSHIPS

Choose a relationship for each of the other player characters, or make up your own

- At your service mistress
- Who are you to judge me
- Mutual respect

- Main Attribute: Empathy
- Main Skill: Manipulation
- Status: 3
- Talents: Loyal, Gossip, Innocuous
- Resources: 1-4
- Equipment: Knife, Lamp or makeup kit, field kitchen or simple bandages

WRITER

I was not born here in Tokyo, but from a neighboring province. As a child, in the woods, I became close to a boy, and would sing, play, and write poetry with him for hours. I never met his family, nor have I ever seen him in our village, but from sunrise to sunset, we were inseparable. That is until my parents decided to leave for Tokyo to try our luck in the city. He came to watch me depart, I ran to him to give him a final goodbye, but when I followed him around a corner, he was gone. The four-day journey was not as dull as I was afraid it to be, for I got to draw many sketches of a fox that had kept pace with us all the way to the city outskirts. In the new capital, however, we started a business, but it eventually failed. I took up writing to support my family and became quite popular, under a pen name, of course. It wasn't easy due to my family's social status, and even more so because I was not born a man. I started out writing short stories, and eventually fell in love with my mentor, who, unbeknown to my knowledge, was a well-known womanizer. This world is just not fair. Even if the direction of the country is changing, is it changing for me or my sisters? Most of my writings now voice this unfairness, and even though society won't pay me attention, at least in my writings, my plight is immortal.



Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

PROFESSIONS

- Poet
- Author
- Journalist

MOTIVATION

- Finding a certain Ukiyo
- Researching a book
- Revenge

TRAUMA

- Fell in love with a Hi-ningenteki na ikemono (supernatural creature).
- Lost a younger sibling to Kappa (river spirit) while swimming in the river.
- I once stole a sake offering from a shrine; that same night, my family life savings disappeared.

DARK SECRET

- I record and use the secrets and weaknesses of my friends ·
- I am wanted for revolutionary ideas ·
- My life's work is a lie.

RELATIONSHIPS

Choose a relationship for each of the other player characters, or make up your own

- You inspire me.
- Tries to win your appreciation.
- You frighten me.

- Main Attribute: Empathy
- Main Skill: Inspiration
- Status: 5
- Talents: Automatic Writing, Journalist, Word-smith
- Resources: 2-5
- Equipment: Writing utensils and paper, camera or opera glasses, pet dog or book collection.

Talents and Equipment



GENERAL TALENTS

Martial Artist (Jui-Jitsu): You have studied martial arts and have developed your body and mind as focused weapons. You gain +2 dice to all combat maneuvers using Force including fist attacks, parries, and grapples.

Karate (Replaces Puglist): You have studied the Okinawan art of Karate, allowing you to strike with force. When using Force for close combat you may increase damage by one.

Arts of Refinement: You are trained in one of the three arts (Ikebana (Flower ceremony), Chado (Tea ceremony), Kodo (Incense ceremony)). When you practice one of these arts you may use Inspiration to heal your own conditions, in addition to healing others.

Nitojutsu (Way of the Two Swords): You have trained in the style of Miyamoto Mushashi and can use both the Katana and Wakizashi at the same time in combat. Gain +2 dice to close combat when wielding both weapons. Note that carrying and using two swords openly is illegal.

Kyudo (The art of Zen Bow): You have studied at a Kyudojo, practicing the art of bow. When attacking with a bow you may ignore all penalties from any condition.

The Gateless Gate: You are trained in the arts of Zen Buddhist practice. Ignore the first Condition gained from a failed Fear Test in a session.

Chinkon (Calming of the Spirits) replaces The lord's shepherd: See the Lord's Shepherd in the core rules.

Shimenawa: You have mastered the Art of using Shimenawa to ward a place from Evil Spirits (1 Success = 1 Automatic Success to Resist a Spell or Effect within a warded place). May only be done once per Scenario.

ARCHETYPE TALENTS

Officer Talents

- **Battle-hardened** (See p. 52 core rules)
- **Gentleman** (See p. 52 core rules)
- **Tactician** (See p. 52 core rules)

Police Officer Talents

- **Eagle Eye** (See p. 53 core rules)
- **Elementary** (See p. 53 core rules)
- **Focused** (See p. 53 core rules)

Priest Talent

- **Absolution**: (See p. 52 core rules), the absolution requires that the player undertake a ritual purification.
- **Blessing**: (See p. 52 core rules)
- **Confessor**: (See p. 52 core rules)

Academic Talents

- **Bookworm** (See p. 50 core rules)
- **Erudite** (See p. 50 core rules)
- **Knowledge is Reassuring** (See p. 50 core rules)

Warrior Talents

- **Sword Drawing Technique (Iaijutsu):** When striking before your opponent in the first round of combat, your opponent can not block, dodge, or parry your attack. If your opponent has the Iaijutsu talent they may attempt to dodge (and only dodge) your attack.
- **Mastery of both Pen and Sword (Bun-bu-ryōdō):** Bushi are expected to master more than just the arts of war, they are also expected to be accomplished courtiers. You may add two dice to any inspiration roll involving courtly arts (Ink Painting, Poetry, Calligraphy).
- **Righteousness (Gi):** A Bushi is expected to proceed from their own righteousness, and do what needs to be done. With this talent, you may push once per session any roll ignoring any conditions you currently have including broken.

Doctor Talents

- **Army Medic** (See p. 50 core rules)
- **Chief Physician** (See p. 50 core rules)
- **Emergency Medicine** (See p. 50 core rules)

Entertainer Talents

- **Seductive**: You are a paragon of grace. Others fall in love with you in a moment. You may use inspiration in place of manipulation when charming or using seduction to achieve an outcome.
- **Dancer**: You are a skilled acrobat or dancer. When attacked you may add +2 dice to dodge an attack
- **Floating World:** You may assist others to reach a state of calm when using Inspiration to reduce conditions. You may heal three conditions instead of two with each success.

Hunter Talents

- **Bloodhound** (See p. 50 core rules)
- **Herbalist** (See p. 50 core rules)
- **Marksman** (See p. 50 core rules)

Shaman / Shrine Maiden Talents

- **Use all your senses:** You ignore mental conditions when using your observation.
- **Kuchiyose**: You conduct the rituals that compel the dead to return and speak, see Medium in the core book.
- **Tamayori Hime** (Bride of the Kami): You summon the rage of your husband, See Strike Fear in the core book.

Servants Talent

- **Loyal** (See p. 53 core rules)
- **Gossip**: Gain +2 when using Manipulation to convince staff to share information on their employers (e.g., Servants, Farmers, Common soldiers, and shop staff).
- **Innocuous**: As per Hobo Tricks (See p. 53 core rules)

Writer Talent

- Automatic Writing (See p. 53 core rules)
- Journalist (See p. 53 core rules)
- Word-smith (See p. 53 core rules)

EQUIPMENT AND SERVICES

These tables extend the Vaesen core rule book equipment and services tables are intended to be used in conjunction with those tables. Mythic Japan has access to all equipment identified in the core rulebook. These additional items are specific to Japan and are mostly holdovers from the Tokugawa period.

Equipment				
Item	Bonus	Availability	Effect	Description
Tea Set	1	4	Use Inspire to reduce Mental Conditions	Cups and teapot.
Calligraphy Set	1		Use Inspire to create artworks	Ink and brush.
Chochin	1	1	Use Investigation in Darkness and detect sneaking people with vigilance	Paper lantern.
Prayer Beads	1		Use Inspire to Ward a person from a Hi-ningenteki	A beaded chain.
Incense	1	3	Use Incense to Manipulate people undertaking meditation	A scented burning stick.
Shamisen	1	2	Influence listeners with Inspiration	A three-stringed guitar.
Painted Scroll	2	3	Find information for learning	A story scroll.
Shakujo	1	3	If Buddhist Monk use Inspire to damage a Hi-ningenteki	Buddhist priest's staff.
Abacus	1	2	Use Learning to rapidly calculate totals and check numbers	A manual calculator.
Sake (Fine)	1	3	Use Inspire with Alcohol	A rice based alcohol.

Services an Establishments			
Services	Availability	Effect	Description
Stay at an Onsen	3	Overnight accommodation and rest with access to relaxing baths heals one condition	An inn with hot-springs.
Rickshaw	1	Travel to a new location and heal one condition	A man pulled cart.
Partake in Shinto Ritual	2	Heal two mental conditions	A religious ritual.
Attend Noh Performance	3	Heal one mental condition	Musical theatre.
Attend Kabuki Performance	2	Heal one mental condition	Masked dance performance.

Melee Weapons						
Weapon	Damage	Range	Bonus	Availability	Skill	Description
Fist (Martial Arts)	1	0	2	–	Force + Talent	
Sai	1	0	1	1	Close Combat (see below)	A three-pronged knife.
Tanto	1	0	1	1	Close Combat	A short sword used as a knife
Wakazashi	1	0	2	4	Close Combat	A Japanese short sword.
Katana	2	0	2	4	Close Combat	A Japanese longsword.
Sasumata	2	0	1	3	Close Combat	A fork-like pole-arm.
Kusarigama	1	0	2	3	Close Combat + Talent	A combined chain-sickle.
Naginata	3	0	1	4	Close Combat	A bladed pole-arm.
Tetsubo	3	0	0	4	Close Combat	A spiked club

Ranged Weapons						
Weapon	Damage	Range	Bonus	Availability	Skill	Description
Yumi	2	1–3	1	4	Ranged Combat	An asymmetrical bow.
Shuriken	1	0–1	1	2	Ranged Combat	A throwing star.
Knife (thrown)	1	0–1	1	1	Ranged Combat	A throwing knife.
Fusil Modèle	2	1–3	2	4	Ranged Combat	A French semi-automatic rifle.
Grandpas Tanegashima	2	1–2	1	3	Ranged Combat	A matchlock musket.

Conflict - Key Themes to Drive Adventures



What follows are several potential areas of conflict for GMs to explore as they create and play in Mythic Japan.

HUMAN ON HUMAN CONFLICT

1. All castes, high and low, shall be united in vigorously carrying out the administration of state affairs.

2. The common people, no less than the civil and military officials, shall all be allowed to pursue their own calling so that there may be no discontent.

Upending of Caste

During the Meiji Period, Japan moves from a highly stratified culture comprised of four castes with no real social mobility to a culture that, at least on the surface claims, to be casteless. These changes upended not just 250 years of Tokugawa rules, but fractured society, leading to multiple uprisings, civil wars, and political assassinations. There is a rich vein of discontent to be explored - particularly as mercantile pursuits become dominant in a society that had previously seen these activities as low. Bushi who had been at the top of society found themselves adrift, many attempting and failing to succeed in business. At the same time, Merchants used to the ebb and flow of financial activities thrived. The government builds factories, villages emptied, and daughters and sons of both Bushi and farmers end up working in unspeakable conditions to increase the wealth of Merchants.

Antagonists

- Displaced bushi
- Greedy ex-daimyos
- Government officials
- Priests

Ending Traditional Gender Roles

The Tokugawa period was intensely patriarchal. Society valued women for their contribution to the household and success of their families through their ability to link dynastic houses, work in the fields, or produce goods for sale. However, several roles existed outside of this traditional framework. In particular, women were capable of becoming warriors in their own right, and lead some shrines - particularly in the Shinto tradition. Women were expected to be educated, brave and industrious in most if not all castes. The Meiji Restoration reduced the role of women in public life, constrained education initially, and stripped them of many of the rights that they previously held. The response of spirits to this dramatic change in the role of women could be a resource for further exploration through a mystery?

Antagonists

- Displaced bushi
- Government officials
- Priests
- Offended Kami



End of Rural Society

Japan, under the Tokugawa Shogunate, had already started a movement toward an intensely urban society. However, power and authority still derived from landholdings. The Japanese measured wealth in Koku, a direct measure of rice required to feed an individual. Farmers were given higher status than both merchants and artisans as productive workers of the land. These certainties were overturned in rapid order by the Meiji Restoration, with changes including:

1. Governors replaced daimyos,
2. Boshi lost their rights to a yearly stipend of Koku,
3. Farmers and their daughters moved to the cities abandoning their farms for the illusory promise of wealth.
4. Merchants and Artisans raise in status, daimyos and bushi become industry leaders.

Antagonists

- Displaced boshi
- Angry farmers
- Avaricious industrialists
- Engineers
- Offended Kami
- Yurei

THE CONFLICT BETWEEN HI-NINGENTEKI AND HUMANS

The conflict between humans and Hi-ningenteki is a crucial component of the game. These conflicts are a natural result of the interaction of the two worlds, as represented by Humans and Hi-ningenteki. Both parties have their agendas, goals, and needs, which create natural conflicts.

Punishment

Unlike Vaesen, some Hi-ningenteki are creatures of pure punishment with clear responsibility for punishing transgressors and delivering vengeance on those that have offended either the Hi-ningenteki or the natural order of things. Many Yurei seek revenge for past wrongs on the original transgressor, the transgressor's family, or humanity as a whole.

Antagonists

- AmmeOnna
- Wahnyudo
- Jurogomo

Resources

Human industry damages the natural environment and drives many particular Kami and Yokai mad. Streams and forests are the battlegrounds of these conflicts as the local Kami or Yokai engage in protecting existing resources from the depredations of humans.

Antagonists

- Kawauso
- Kappa
- Yuki-No-Onna

Tricksters

Japanese folklore is full of stories of Hi-ningenteki taking advantage of humanity's greed and simple nature. In many cases, these stories are focused on teaching the human a lesson. Shapeshifters in particular play long cons on gullible humans, ending with the Yokai making off with the wealth of the person or leaving them destitute.

Antagonists

- Tanuki
- Kitsune
- Sazae Oni
- Tengu
- Bakeneko

Tradition

Some Hi-ningenteki are concerned with the right way of doing things. These Hi-ningenteki expect traditions to be observed and protect not just their own but also the human ways of doing things. As the culture itself changes, they become angry, and resent humans for their abandonment of the traditional ways.

Antagonists

- Tengu
- Shikigami
- Sazae Oni
- Spirit court
- Kami

Servants

There are several servant Hi-ningenteki in existence who are bound to protect and serve families and sorcerers. In Mythic Japan, these servant spirits are tasked with various evil and benign tasks by their owners, which may place them in conflict with players.

Antagonists

- Inugami
- Shikigami

Yurei, Yokai, and Oni

THE SUPERNATURAL AND JAPANESE SOCIETY

Shinto and the Hi-ningenteki na ikemono

Shinto is a living religion, practiced in Japan by a large portion of the population and central to Japanese national identity. In creating the game of Mythic Japan, we have been careful to ensure that this game respects those religious practices. We have avoided making use of Major Kami (In particular the key figures in Shinto like Amaterasu, Izanagi & Izanami, and Inari). We strongly suggest that any game set within Mythic Japan should avoid use of either major Kami or Bodhivistas as antagonists.

AMEONNA (RAIN WOMAN)

It was true that the winds along the coast of Nagoya are strong and that children are warned to not go out in the storms, but there are always those who seek to push the boundaries and take risks. As the winds and heavy rain ruthlessly pound on the streets and the buildings, restless children feel drawn to the outside and adventure. The children's restlessness troubles a mother, who woken by a sudden increase in the volume of the rain woke to check on her children. She was alone that night, her husband Kanji was travelling the roads between Nagoya and Osaka and would be gone for some days. As she steps through the house, her footfalls masked by the sound of hail and driving rain, she hears a wail outside, like a sobbing woman. Now she races to the bedroom of her oldest child, to discover the shutters open and water pooling under the window. Racing to space she sees a lonely figure, illuminated for just a second by a strike of lightning. A single woman, her mouth full of teeth, wet and pushed down by the beating rain, glances back at her, smiles and disappears as the light from the lighting dissipates. She never found her oldest child, but now whenever a storm or heavy rain strikes she stalks the halls of the house, afraid of what might happen to her other children.

Like many cultures in the world, rain in Japan came with its own set of superstitious myths involving the rain, like that of the ameonna. The ameonna can be found walking the streets during heavy rain showers searching for children to steal in a large sack which they carry everywhere they go. Mothers of the children that are stolen by ameonna become cursed with never ending grief and despair, and in turn, becomes an ameonna herself, thus perpetuating the cycle. It is not entirely known what the Ameonna eat, but they are frequently seen vigorously licking the rain drops off of their arms. Others speculate that the ameonna might even eat some of the children that they have taken, especially male children.



The ameonna are horrifying creatures of the winds and the storms that have such a destructive impact on Japan. In ages past they were present when the house was torn down through the actions of a great storm and this should not be forgotten. They are far more readily identified as evil than their close relatives the Yuki Onna.

CONDITIONS

- Cannot be harmed in physical combat

MAGICAL ABILITIES

- Enchant
- Curse
- Cannot be harmed in combat

RITUAL

An ameonna is a pure spirit without a trus physical form. Destroying this spirit requires the application of powerful sutra's and chants. The other method for defeat is to connect two Ameonna ending the cycle of pain and dispair that drives them.

SECRET

There is a good chance that an ameonna might respond favorably to another ameonna, for the two just might be related. If a mother and daughter were to become reconnected, then this would potentially end the conflict and cycle.

CHARACTERISTICS

Might: - Body Control: - Magic: 10
Manipulation: 10 Fear: 2/1

COMBAT

A Rain Woman cannot be engaged in physical combat.

EXAMPLES OF CONFLICTS

- It has been raining in town for 3 months straight. If this keeps up, the town will face a serious famine. What is responsible for this never ending downpour, and is there anything that can be done to resolve this situation
- Children have gone missing in the village, but the townsfolk are reluctant to talk or speculate about ameonna, for fear that if they acknowledge her existence, she will visit them next.
- An Ameonna has been searching for its missing daughter, bringing heavy rain and storms all the way down the coast. The Daisan No Me are called upon to respond to the growing threat, stopping the path of destruction before it claims yet more lives.

INUGAMI (DOG GOD)

A man of hatred and despair was angered by what had been done to him in the Emperor's name. Taking a dog he forced it to starve and then placed it in mortal combat with several others of its kind. Victorious he offered it food and promised it and his ongoing worship of it if it would strike the emperor down. The Emperor fell ill, struck down by the curse placed on him by the Inugami. Luckily the Emperor's sister, a priestess of the royal court was able to see the spirit and talk to it, allowing her to identify the source of the curse. Members of the Fujiwara clan, advisors to the Emperor, listened as the priestess described the creature in some detail. The lady followed the trail of the Inugami to the house of the actual sorcerer, a distant relative of the Emperor who felt slighted. Locating the bones of the dog spirit was easy, and then she used them to place a curse on the family of the sorcerer. Desperate to escape the curse, the wife of the sorcerer raced to the location of the bones and began to dig up the skeleton. The Lady stepped from the darkness, surrounded by Fujiwara retainers, and captured the sorcerer and his family. The sorcerer was forced to destroy the bones, and the curse was lifted from the Emperor.

The Inugami is a servant spirit raised against its will through the practice of Koduku or curse magic by a practitioner of ancient arts. The Inugami's spirit is promised ongoing worship by its summoner and is lured into believing that this worship will sustain it. The Inugami possesses its victim at the request of the sorcerer who summoned it, it can possess any man, woman or child as well as domestic animals. The creature itself is tied to its bones and its remains, which are normally buried at a crossroads or place of significance.

Inugami are created through the application of horrific rituals, all of which involve cruelty, starvation and mutilation of the corpse of the dog. Any who would complete the ritual and apply the necessary pain to the animals in question are universally condemned and the arts they practice have been outlawed for a thousand years. The Daisan No Me are obligated by ancient agreements and promises to hunt all who would undertake such magic and end them.



CONDITIONS

- Bitter 0
- Angry +1
- Hateful +2
- Dazed -2
- Confused -1 Roll randomly to assign the target
- Whining - 2 The Inugami starts to make a pitiful whine as it regresses to its prespirit form.
- Broken: In 1d6 hours The Inugami is driven from the body of the person it has possessed, the creature reforms at the location of its bones and then travels to the sorcerer who commands it

MAGICAL ABILITIES

- Curse
- Possess (The Inugami has no physical form of its own and must possess the body of another) Roll Magic versus the Empathy of the Target on three successes the Inugami may force the body to do its Masters bidding.
- Cannot be harmed when in spirit form (Except through the application of talents)

RITUAL

An exorcist may drive the Inugami from the body of the person whom it possesses, this ritual must be undertaken at night and requires the special skills of a priestess or priest versed in the ways of Onmyoji (Natural Magics).

The Inugami creator must be hunted down and either forced to undo the spell that summoned it or killed to end the threat.

SECRET

The Inugami bones and body must be dug up and destroyed while the ritual is undertaken to permanently end the creature. Otherwise it will become a haunting Onryo driven to seek revenge on all those who pass by the place of its burial.

CHARACTERISTICS

Might: 0/9 Body Control: 0/8 Magic: 8 Manipulation: NA Fear: 2/1

COMBAT

Bite Damage 2 Reach 0 (only while possessing another)

EXAMPLES OF CONFLICTS

- A village has suffered a series of violent outbreaks, villagers have been attacking each other in the street and doing violence to each other for no apparent reason. The Headman is at a loss regarding why the violence is occurring and cannot explain what is troubling their village. Unbeknownst to the Headman the violence is being caused by a Inugami whose master was recently killed, potentially by the Players. The violence is located around the burial point of the Inugami.
- A sorcerer has been working to create an Inugami from the local dog population, a number of horrifically mutilated dogs have been appearing in the alleys of the local town. The Daisan No Me have noted the carcasses and are aware of the actions and must now track down the Sorcerer before they complete their rituals. The creature is of course created just as the players finally track down the Sorcerer who uses it against the players.
- A sorcerer is using an Inugami to manipulate the local police commander and ensure that their enemies are tracked down and punished. The police chief's actions are causing great distress in the population and are leading to resistance from the community. Open revolt is only a few weeks away and the police chief's actions make no sense. Driving the community into revolt is not actually the sorcerer's intent, but they actually don't care if it happens.

JUROGOMO (SPIDER WIFE)

In the town of Ichikawa, there was a young farmer named Hinata Daichi. His family was poor, their rice harvest had been small for the past few years, and he feared he would have to sell his farm. His two eldest daughters had already left to work in the new factories in the city. The winter was cold and dry, Hinata had to travel far, seeking water for his family. On one of his journeys, he came across a young woman sitting alone by the roadside. The young woman asked Hinata if he would lend her his shoes, for hers had broken and her feet were sore from her travels. Hinata saw that the young woman was weary, and despite his own tired feet, he took off his shoes and gave them to the young woman. The young woman told him that his generosity would be rewarded. The farmer did not know what she meant - when he returned home though, he found the rice fields healthy and flourishing. Hinata knew then that the young woman had been a Kitsune. His family's farm was successful from then on and he made sure to teach all of his children to be kind and generous to all.



Jurogomo like other shapeshifters are old, so old that once they have lived for four hundred years they gain magical abilities. The Jurogomo feeds on its prey, and like any good mother provides for her children. She hunts men by preference to her original fare of flies and birds, finding their bodies full of delicious flavours. A Jurogomo can only take a single form, but her charm and entrapment spells are enough to capture even the most resistant of prey. Like all spiders, the Jurogomo looks for haunts where one's webs are hard to see, so they are often found in places of shadow and darkness. Jurogomo can be found at wayside Inns, Caves and the attics of houses.

Whilst a Jurogomo is usually only interested in feeding on the bodies of their victims, it is not impossible for a Jurogomo to fall in love with a Human. In these rarest of cases, a Jurogomo will swear its former meal ticket to absolute secrecy. Seeking to protect its secret from the greater populace. Should the men break the promise a Jurogomo will seek to exact vengeance oathbreaker, punishing them and possibly those that now know the secret of the Jurogomo.

A Jurogomo is usually accompanied by her children, who she cares for with the love of a diligent mother. Her most important motivation is to ensure her children are well-fed, protected and cared for. Should some injury occur to her children then woe betides the one who caused the injury.

CONDITIONS

- Spiteful +1
- Cautious (Lures using Seduction)
- Dazed - 1
- Angered +1 (Uses its webs to trap the Heroes)
- Bleeding -1
- Shattered- 2 (Takes the form of spider)
- Broken - Takes the form of a thousand spiders and retreats into the safe dark spaces in its cave or home

MAGICAL ABILITIES

- Enchant
- Curse
- Webbing: Can capture opponents in webs of steel
- Shift: Can turn into a giant spider (increase Fear to 2 and Might to 10)
- Scuttle: Can travel through trapdoors and instantly appear in another location around a house or cave
- Swarm: When under significant threat they are known to take the form of a 1,000 small spiders spreading out from a single point.
- Lure: Jurogomo is beautiful and seductive by nature: A Jurogomo can lure a person of the opposite sex using manipulation versus observation into its arms.

RITUAL

A Jurogomo must be completely destroyed for it to be defeated, every one of the thousand spiders must be hunted down and destroyed, and their place of power levelled, burnt down or drowned in a flood. A Jurogomo are vain creatures and will avoid killing an avid flatterer while they compliment the Jurogomo.

SECRET

Foe a Jurogomo to be finally defeated Buddhist sutras must be recited in the place of its power even as that place is destroyed.

CHARACTERISTICS

Might: 6 Body Control: 8 Magic: 8
Manipulation: 10 Fear: 1

COMBAT

Bite Damage 1 Range 0 (Plus Toxicity 9 - Paralyzing Poison)
Hurl Flaming Spiders Fire Intensity 2 Range 1-2

EXAMPLES OF CONFLICTS

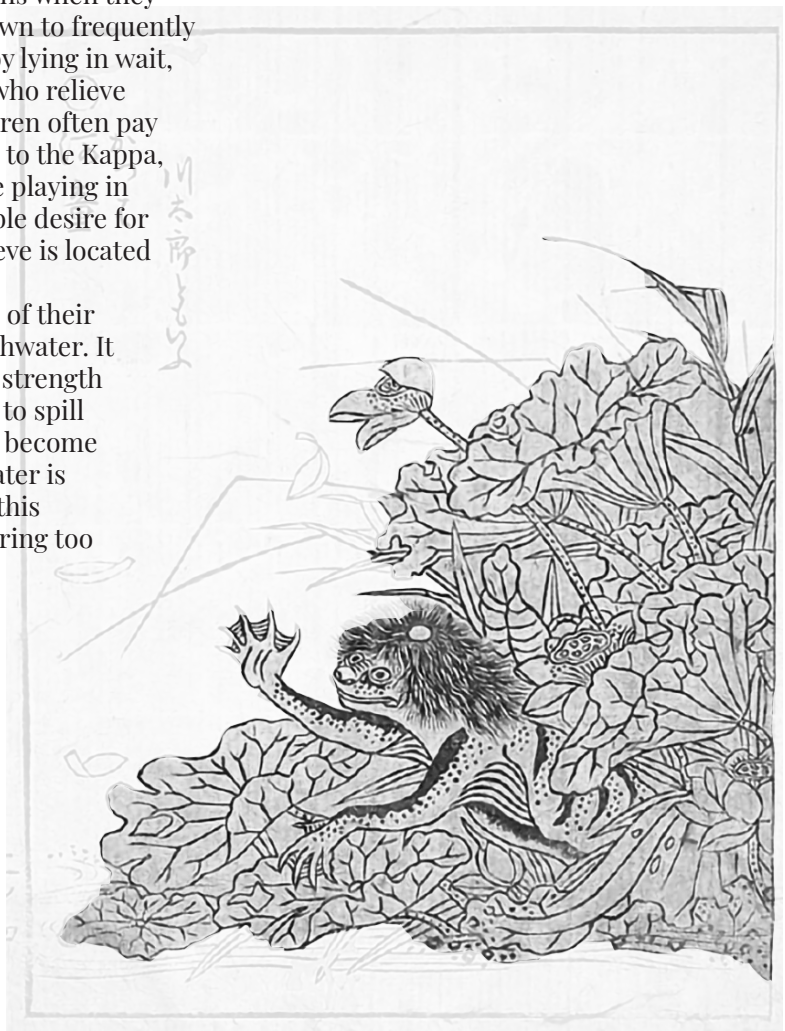
- A Jorogomo has taken up residence in an Old Inn and is using her magic to make the Inn look beautiful and inviting. Every night new visitors stop at the Inn and find themselves enjoying the food and company of a beautiful Biwa Player. On the morning one less traveller leaves the Inn than arrived on the night before.
- A small village has been protected from a range of dangers through an ancient pact with a local Jurogomo. Every few years a child is fostered by one of the families of the village, replacing one of their own. This year the fostered child has been taken away by a local gang angering the Jorogomo and placing the village in a desperate situation.
- The characters are ill, and a visit to the local hospital allows them a chance at rest and recovery. However, the Nurse who is visiting them is actually a Jorogomo in disguise, feeding on those who are weak she has been killing the sick for food. Her meals are kept in the basement and are awaiting the players to discover them.

KAPPA (RIVER YOKAI)

Just like yesterday's journal entry and the day before, another one of our oxen was found mutilated today, this time by Yukito. Even now, he clings to my arm as I write this, scared and still unable to express to Sayaka or I what is wrong. If only he was a little older, for I believe he saw what has been terrorizing our livestock and our village.

Poor Nagaoka-san′s wife came by earlier today as well and was shook with worry. She said Nagaoka-san did not return home last night after he left to relieve himself in the river. I worry the old man might have fallen in, but I just don't have the heart to tell her. He is the second person this month to go missing. What is happening to our village, and what was it that you saw today Yuki-kun.

Kappas are humanoid creatures with a large shell, scaled bodies, and webbed appendages. Their heads resemble a twisted parody of a man, with a balding head and pointed beak. Kappas can be found in, and around large bodies of fresh water or rivers. While they are often usually mischievous in nature, they have been known to carry out violent acts to unfortunate humans when they are provoked. Kappas have been known to frequently vent their frustrations on mankind by lying in wait, drowning poor unsuspecting locals who relieve themselves in the rivers. Sadly, children often pay the price for their parent's misdeeds to the Kappa, by finding themselves attacked while playing in the waters. Kappa's have an unsuitable desire for eating human souls, which they believe is located deep within the anuses of humans.
Kappas have a deep crater in the top of their skulls that house a small pool of freshwater. It is this water that gives the Kappa its strength and energy. If the water is somehow to spill from their head, then the Kappa will become immobilized instantly, until fresh water is placed back into their head. It is for this reason alone that Kappa's fear venturing too far from a source of freshwater.



CONDITIONS

- Undertow - attempts to drown an opponent
- Angry +1
- Desperate + 2 Grapples with an opponent
- Confused -1
- Exhausted -2
- Last Gasp +1 Attempts to flee the conflict
- Broken (turns into a scum on the water and reforms at the head of the river in 1D6 hours)

MAGICAL ABILITIES

- Drowning - A Kappa can use its might to cause a person to drown.
- Creature can gain an extra movement phase while in water.
- Concealed in Water - while underwater a kappa is undetectable to human eyes.

RITUAL

While Kappas can be killed in the traditional manner, they can also be subdued if the water that occupies the crater on top of their head spills out. If all the water is to fall from their head, they will become immediately immobilized until fresh water is placed back into the head.

SECRET

There is no secret Kappa are a transparent and angry Yokai, but not one with complex motivations or weaknesses.

CHARACTERISTICS

Might: 8 Body Control: 9 Magic: 6
Manipulation: 8 Fear: 1

COMBAT

Claw Damage 1 Range 0
Bite Damage 2 Range 0
Grapple - As per combat rules (use Might)

EXAMPLES OF CONFLICTS

- A local Daimyo has been given reports from the countryside that livestock and horses have been found mutilated in the fields.
- People have been disappearing and later found floating in the river. The village is scared and has requested aid in discovering what has happened to the town. Everyone is on edge, and no one trusts each other.
- Some of the town's folk have been found dead by the riverside, with their intestines protruding out through their buttocks. The locals believe this to be the work of Kappa's and are in desperate need of help in locating and extinguishing them.

KAWUSO (OTTER)

Long, long ago, in the Province of Ishikawa, many young men were lured to the river's edge, drowned and eaten by a magical shapeshifter - this is the story of Kawauso. There was a beautiful river in the Province of Ishikawa which was visited often by young men and women in love. The Kawauso who lived in the river was old and tired of playing the simple tricks of the past. When the young couple approached the river, the Kawauso would mimic their voices, separating the couple and luring them individually into the river. As the young man entered the river, the Kawauso would appear in the form of their young lover, laughing and giggling, begging them to come deeper into the river. The young man would be found later that day, half eaten, lying on the river bank, the girl would never be found again. This went on for many months, until the Shoya of the village was forced to act by the families of the dead couples. The Shoya consulted with the Miko of the local shrine, who blessed the village fishing nets. The next time a young couple approached the river and the Kawauso appeared, nets were thrown over it. The Kawauso, a shapeshifter of great skill, tried to escape the net, shifting to the form of a fish and then when that failed, water itself. The men of the village pulled the Kawauso from the river and beat it with clubs. When you go to the village shrine in the Province of Ishikawa you can find a beautiful Kawauso pelt adorning the Miko's shoulders and the children of the river can bathe without fear.

The Kawauso is a shapeshifter, like many animals it gains magical powers as it ages. Perhaps a greater shapeshifter than either the Kitsune or the Tanuki. The Kawauso can be found in rivers all through Japan - unlike the Kappa, it is more prone to the use of magic and less interested in physical confrontation. The Kawauso will often be seen on the river bank, wearing rich clothing and parading around in imitation of the humans it plays tricks on. Kawauso are not bound to the rivers in the same way that the Kappa is - they will often creep into villages nearby, playing their tricks on humans in their homes.

A Kawauso is normally only interested in playing tricks on the humans of the surrounding area. It will cause lanterns to go out at night, mimic the voice of young women, and take the form of a young lover. It often masquerades as a beautiful girl to trick young men into doing foolish things. As it ages, some Kawauso become bitter and twisted, their appetites changing to a taste for human flesh - these are the most terrifying of all. They will leave the half-eaten bodies of their victims by the water's edge and need to be driven away or killed.



CONDITIONS

- Trickster - plays minor tricks on the humans
- Insulted
- Aggressive +1
- Hungry +2 - attempts to drown a human who comes to close
- Tired -1
- Frightened -2
- Broken - disappears into the water or transforms into a small form and flees from its attackers. It reforms in 1D6 Hours in the river that it resides in.

MAGICAL ABILITIES

- Enchant
- Trollcraft
- Shapeshifter - takes the form of a beautiful human, or a terrible monster.
- Ensnare - can put a man under a spell, forcing him to carry out their whims.
- Fox-fire - can manipulate fire in an area and create fire.
- Gift - can grant a wisdom or extend the life of a human.

RITUAL

The Kawauso can be captured and dragged from the river through the use of river nets and traps. Like many similar shapeshifters if its disguise is broken it will often flee.

SECRET

The Nets used to capture the Kawauso must be blessed to have any chance of affecting them.

CHARACTERISTICS

Might: 8 Body Control: 8 Magic: 8
Manipulation: 8 Fear: 1/0

COMBAT

Tooth and claw Damage 2 Range 0
Drown Damage 2 Range 0 (Note if the Kawuso has lured its victim into the river it will do two damage per turn).

EXAMPLES OF CONFLICTS

- The new town of Takasaki, in the Prefecture of Gunma is experiencing a rash of murders as young men go missing, when they go near the moat that surrounds the old castle. A Kawauso has taken up residence in the moat and has taken to luring the young men by taking the form of their unrequited loves.
- Young girls in the village of Daishigawara are no longer interested in their betrothed. At night a beautiful man steals into their sleeping rooms and makes promises of undying love in return for beautiful silver fish. This is a Kawauso who has taken to tricking humans into giving it its favourite food.
- Several river boats on the Tama River have become lost at night when all of the lanterns on the boat suddenly go out. The last three have run aground on mysterious sand banks that have appeared out of nowhere. A Kappa and a Kawauso have joined forces to drive human traffic from their river.

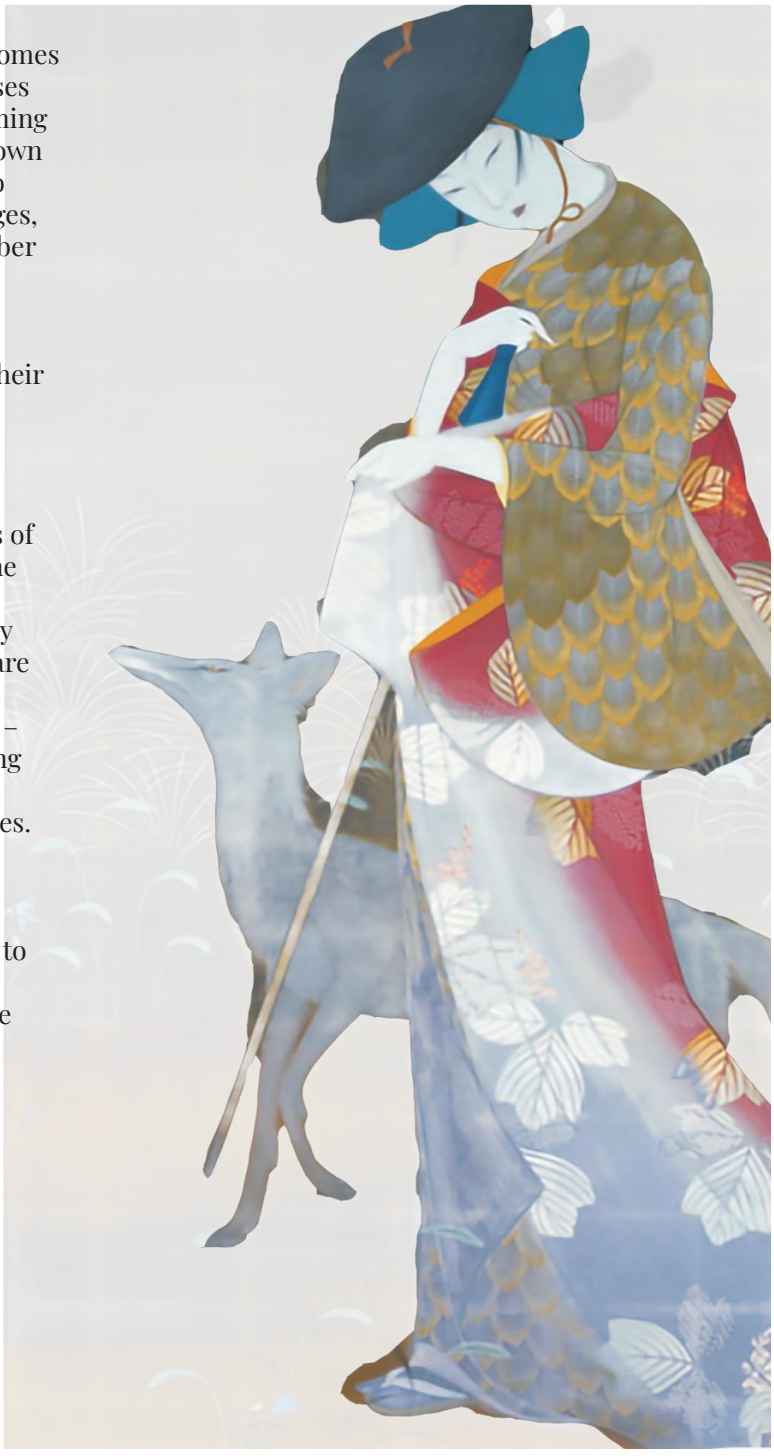
KITSUNE (FOX WIFE)

In the town of Ichikawa, there was a young farmer named Hinata Daichi. His family was poor, their rice harvest had been small for the past few years, and he feared he would have to sell his farm. His two eldest daughters had already left to work in the new factories in the city. The winter was cold and dry, Hinata had to travel far, seeking water for his family. On one of his journeys, he came across a young woman sitting alone by the roadside. The young woman asked Hinata if he would lend her his shoes, for hers had broken and her feet were sore from her travels. Hinata saw that the young woman was weary, and despite his own tired feet, he took off his shoes and gave them to the young woman. The young woman told him that his generosity would be rewarded. The farmer did not know what she meant - when he returned home though, he found the rice fields healthy and flourishing. Hinata knew then that the young woman had been a Kitsune. His family's farm was successful from then on and he made sure to teach all of his children to be kind and generous to all.

When a fox reaches a wise age, it becomes a Kitsune. A creature of trickery, it uses illusions to cause mischief, transforming itself and the world around it for its own amusement, and manipulating fire to frighten its victims. As the Kitsune ages, its power grows, along with the number of tails it possesses. In human form they often pose as beautiful women, marrying young men and building families, only to have to leave when their true nature is discovered.

The older Kitsune are often more malicious in their pranks, targeting poor farmers and burning the homes of those who anger them. Young Kitsune on the other hand are more playful, the victims of their pranks are usually greedy or boastful humans. Kitsune are angered by those who would be rude to them or take more than they need – but they can also be generous, offering gifts of wisdom or long life to those who are kind and generous themselves.

The Kitsune described here is a Nogitsune (wild fox). There are two other kinds of Kitsune you may want to include in your game. The first is the Hito-Kitsune (man-fox), a weasel-like fox in its natural state. It is a demon which possesses young women, ruining their family's reputation and torturing their hosts. The second is the Inari (white fox), who works as a servant to the gods, protecting shrines and punishing foxes who would commit evils.



CONDITIONS

- Insulted
- Seductive +1
- Angry +2
- Dazed
- Bleeding -1
- Badly injured -2 (transforms into fox form)
- Broken (burns to ash and re-emerges in the forest after 1D6 hours)

MAGICAL ABILITIES

- Enchant
- Trollcraft
- Shapeshifter - takes the form of a beautiful human, or a terrible monster.
- Ensnare - can put a man under a spell, forcing him to carry out their whims.
- Fox-fire - can manipulate fire in an area and create fire.
- Gift - can grant a wisdom or extend the life of a human.

RITUAL

The Kitsune is afraid of dogs, the only creature who can see through their disguise. To drive away the fox a village matron must lead a dog through the streets, the woman the dog barks at will be told to feed it, if she is a Kitsune, before she can give the dog its meat she will transform, and flee in terror.

SECRET

The dog used to find the Kitsune must be wearing a bell blessed by a Shinto priestess. If the dog is not wearing the bell it cannot see through the fox's disguise.

CHARACTERISTICS

Might: 8 Body Control: 9 Magic: 10
Manipulation: 10 Fear: 0

COMBAT

Tooth and claw Damage 2 Range 0
Burn Damage 1 Range 0-2

EXAMPLES OF CONFLICTS

- A Nogitsune has been stealing from the local community, accumulating a surprising list of important goods and money. The Nogitsune has also been engaging in various cruel pranks costing the local villagers horor, respect and sometimes limbs. The Headman knows a kitsune is responsible but is unable to locate the particular culprit.
- A village has depended on the protection of a local Inari who lives in the local shrine and receives offerings. The Inari has come to the knowledge of the local governor who has ordered that the shrine be leveled not understanding that it is an Inari, not a Nogitsune. The Daisan No Me are invited to save the temple from the wrath of the governor who lost someone important to themselves through the action of a Nogitsune.
- A man and woman who have been committing a series of crimes across the entire province have made their way to a local village, both are kitsune. They are both desperate for a rest from the pursuing authorities. The man wishes to continue his reign of terror while the woman has started to mature into an inari. The split in their relationship is leading to a conflict in which the local humans are pawns, being played by each side.

KORORI (CHOLERA PLAGUE SPIRIT)

Tokyo Times, Terror in the Capital. A new evil stalks our streets, one that traditional practices are unable to halt, Cholera is killing our children, the poor and even ministers. The Lord Okubo Toshimichi, Chief Minister to the Emperor has written a book promising protection from the evil plague and strongly advises all loyal citizens of the Emperor to gather together and work together to halt this pandemic before it spreads. The Korori, a representation of the spirit, is being used by advertisers and the government to spread the message of the evils of Cholera, under no circumstances should people assume the Korori is real, created in the workshops of the government, its sole purpose to provide a focus for people to be aware of. Some people have identified a need for protective scrolls and images, in particular the image of the Jinja Hime, as a protection against the spirit. These protective measures do not work according to the Chief Minister and should not replace the advice in relation to plumbing and isolation practices.

Of course, the Korori is just one in a long line of pandemic related Yokai, and the creature is question has now appeared in, fulfilling the dreams and fears of the population. It is a new Yokai and is confused about where it is and why. Unlike the other Yokai, the Korori will not exist in prior documents, so research in the order's library will not be effective. The creature itself is familiar / trapped by modern technology and can be found anywhere. It is depicted as the front part of a tiger, the rear part of a wolf and the genitals of a Tanuki (Raccoon Dog). The creature is infectious and almost impossible to defeat.

The Korori is vulnerable to the works and presence of a Amabie, a protective spirit who wards against disease and is also a recent creation of the minds of the people. This antagonistic relationship between the two imagined Yokai is a critical one to understanding the source of new myths and vibrant mythic culture of Japan



CONDITIONS

- Bitter
- Angry +1
- Hateful +1
- Dazed -1
- Confused -2
- Mad +2 - The creature swaps initiative with a PC if the players choice
- Broken - The creature disappears in a bitter and acrid smelling cloud of dust, all players near the creature must make a Force roll with a challenging difficulty (2 successes). Any player who fails becomes infected (see Magical Powers). The creature reforms at this location over the next day, reappearing at the cocks crow the next morning.

MAGICAL ABILITIES

- Curse
- Invisibility: the Korori is capable of amazing feats of invisibility, hiding in plain sight even when faced with the powers of the Daisan No Me. The creature is capable of avoiding vision on the part of the players (who must roll 3 successes on Vigilance Roll).
- Infect: the creature is capable of infecting the players with a magical version of Cholorea, causing a disease of strength 9 (Please use the rules for poison). The Disease has a longer time frame between rolls with a roll being made per day. However, Medicine will only have an effect on the disease if bolstered with the protective image of an Amabie or a Jinja Hime.

RITUAL

The Korori is like many prior plague spirits, vulnerable to the images of protective spirits. A house may be protected from the plague spirit through the application of prayers, painting red across doors and walls and the hanging of images of protective spirits to drive the creature away.

SECRET

The image of the protective creature needs to be recent and based on an actual sighting of the creature in question. The players will need to reach out and locate a protective creature and capture its image to have an effective tool. In addition, destroying the creature requires surrounding it with images and then burning the space the creature is trapped in.

CHARACTERISTICS

Might: 7 Body Control: 7 Magic: 3
Manipulation: 6 Fear: 2/1

COMBAT

Claws Damage 2 - Range 0
Bite Damage 2 - Range 0
Plague Breath - Use Magic Versus Force - Failure causes infection and a condition.

EXAMPLES OF CONFLICTS

- The players are invited to stop a spreading disease, Cholera is spreading across the country. Unbeknownst to the players, the Korori has taken form on the baggage carriage of the Taiko railway line. It is hidden and confused, as its existence is actually a very recent event. The disease spread is following the train line, slowly creeping along the line as the creature spreads its disease from community to community.
- The creature has taken residence in the slums surrounding one of the major cities, for instance Osaka , Kobe or Tokyo itself. The creature is living amongst the people, operating out of an old shrine and causing the disease to spread rom that epicentre.
- The Korori has become embroiled in a conflict of epic proportions with a Amabie, an anti-plague spirit. The conflict between the creatures is playing out in a series of waves of infection and recovery that never seems to end. The players may wish to engage in conflict with both or one of the Yokai to try and end the ongoing infection waves.

ROKOKUBI (LONG NECKED WOMAN)

A man of authority and power, a senior advisor to the Shogun, stole away into the night. By the side of the Advisor, a young lady, wife to one of the minor functionaries of the court travelled with him. The Advisor had persuaded her that in him she had found a perfect love, one who had the wealth and power required to finally allow her to achieve all of her goals. Silently they made their way to an Inn in the Mountains, far from the prying eyes of the court and her husbands family. After a large and hearty dinner, the woman fell almost instantly asleep, for she had no head for Saki. The man, exhausted but keen to complete his conquest of the woman, attempted to wake her up. Rather than waking suddenly the woman's head rose upon an elongated neck, cursed for her infidelity and driven to punish those who have been unfaithful, the next wrapped around the body of the Advisor. Slowly she strangled him to death, choking the contempt he had shown her out of his body. The next day the girl awoke, not realising she was responsible for the dead official she fled the room in terror. Now desperate, she plys the red light district, however, should the man who hires her be unfaithful to his wife, he may not wake the next day.

A Rokurokubi is a woman with an incredibly long neck who while asleep is unable to control their actions. They are driven to take vengeance on deceitful people, often causing them to die as they slowly strangle them to death. While in their monstrous form they cannot be easily killed, however during the day they are as vulnerable as any other person to harm. Their victims are found strangled the next morning, often with clear bruising around their neck and upper chest as if a rope has been used to kill them.

The Rokokubi is a victim and much as they are a monster and often they are completely unaware of their nighttime activities . As such simply ending the Rokurokubi is a difficult thing for a good person to do. Often their curse is a result of the bad actions of a parent, who must make amends to the offended spirit for the curse to be removed.



CONDITIONS

- Hissing
- Offended +1
- Stretching forth +2
- Murderous +2
- Grappling -1
- Badly injured -2 (retreats to its body)
- Broken (Can be killed through normal means)

MAGICAL ABILITIES

- Curse
- Stretching Neck (Note some Rokokubi are able to detach their heads completely from their bodies). There is no limit to the distance their necks can stretch.

RITUAL

A Rokurokubi is often a victim of the misdeeds of its parents. As such the correct rituals involve the parent making amends for thier misdeeds.

SECRET

For the curse to end the parent must enter a monastery giving up all worldly concerns.

CHARACTERISTICS

Might: 8 Body Control: 9 Magic: 10
Manipulation: 10 Fear: 0

COMBAT

Grapple Dam 2 Range Unlimited

EXAMPLES OF CONFLICTS

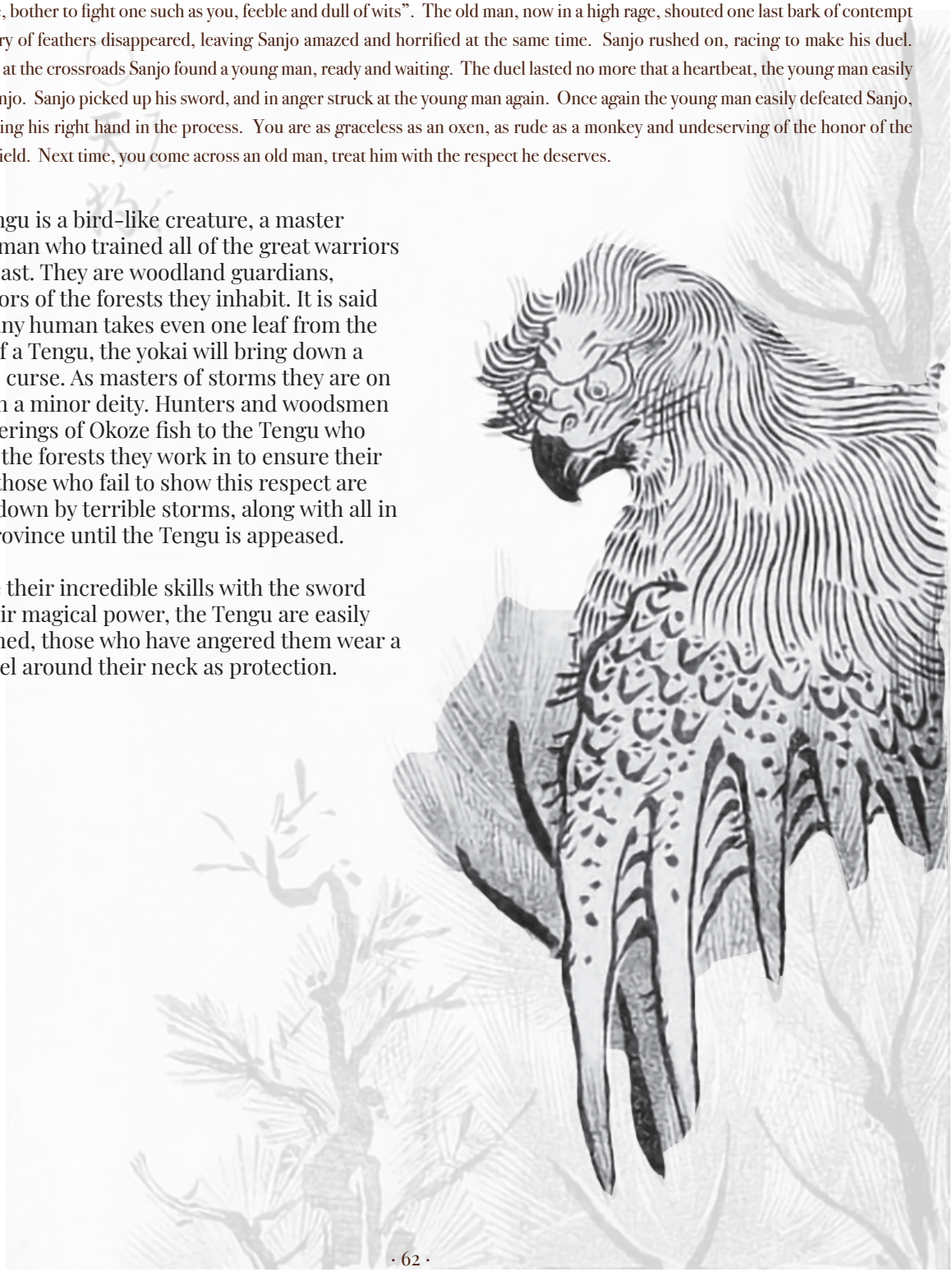
- A series of men have died while staying at a roadside inn. The inn owner has been concealing the cause of death, realising it is their daughter. The owner stole the Inn from the orignal owner killing and burying them under the stable in the back.
- A young maid has recently taken up work in the castle, she has been unable to stay in employment for long as her employers become suspicious of her behaviour and drive her out. She is carrying the Rokurokubi curse and the Daisan No Me may wish to rescue her from the cause of the curse.
- A headless body has recently been found in a local red light district home. The body is of course the body of a Rokurokubi and the head is now looking for the body. There have been multiple sightings of the body and desperate to survive she has taken to feeding on the life force of her victims.

TENGU (MOUNTAIN SPIRIT)

A long time ago, in the province of XX a young Bushi, Sanjo sough to become the greatest swordsman of his generation. He spent his time training under the master's of the sword who lived in his city. Once he had learnt all he could, he travelled the province fighting both Bushi and Ronin across the landscape. Towards the end of one such trip he came upon and old man by the side of the road. Seeking to pass the old man, Sanjo stepped around the old man, pushing him to one side in his desperate need to make it to the duel he had organised. The old man shouted his name "Sanjo, Oh Master of the Sword, but graceless as a failing oxen, how dare you touch me." If you are one so failing in proper manners, I dare you to take out your sword and duel me. Sanjo needless to say, laughed out loud, "Ha Old Man, why would one as skilled as me, bother to fight one such as you, feeble and dull of wits". The old man, now in a high rage, shouted one last bark of contempt and in a flurry of feathers disappeared, leaving Sanjo amazed and horrified at the same time. Sanjo rushed on, racing to make his duel. Upon arrival at the crossroads Sanjo found a young man, ready and waiting. The duel lasted no more that a heartbeat, the young man easily defeating Sanjo. Sanjo picked up his sword, and in anger struck at the young man again. Once again the young man easily defeated Sanjo, this time taking his right hand in the process. You are as graceless as an oxen, as rude as a monkey and undeserving of the honor of the sword you wield. Next time, you come across an old man, treat him with the respect he deserves.

The Tengu is a bird-like creature, a master swordsman who trained all of the great warriors of the past. They are woodland guardians, protectors of the forests they inhabit. It is said that if any human takes even one leaf from the home of a Tengu, the yokai will bring down a terrible curse. As masters of storms they are on par with a minor deity. Hunters and woodsmen give offerings of Okoze fish to the Tengu who inhabit the forests they work in to ensure their safety, those who fail to show this respect are struck down by terrible storms, along with all in their province until the Tengu is appeased.

Despite their incredible skills with the sword and their magical power, the Tengu are easily frightened, those who have angered them wear a mackerel around their neck as protection.



CONDITIONS

- Insulted +1
- Summon a storm
- Enraged +2
- Hail falls in the area
- Unfocussed Fury -1
- Flurry of Blows 0
- Badly hurt -2
- Broken (disappears into the shadows reappears in 2d6 hours in a local shrine)

MAGICAL ABILITIES

- Enchant
- Trollcraft
- Mimicry
- Invisibility
- Weather control

RITUAL

Tengu are honorable teachers of ancient arts and skills and not given to simple or even complex rituals. They may be driven from an area through the use of mackerel, which when combined with certain buddhist rituals can make them uncomfortable. Like the Green Knight however seek warriors who are capable of defeating them in conflict. A tengu may be challenged to a competition of any of the arts of the Pen or the Sword (Haiku, Calligraphy, Ink Painting or Swordsmanship), if defeated they will surrender the field and leave honoring whatever pacts were made prior to the duel being conducted.

SECRET

A tengu can be persuaded to take on a student for a period of time, at the completion of the training the Tengu will move on without a need for conflict. The student must pass rigorous tests before it will take them on, and then they must survive the training. Such a student will gain one point in a skill of their choice or a talent.

CHARACTERISTICS

Might: 10 Body Control: 9 Magic: 10
Manipulation: 6 Fear: 1

COMBAT

Sword Strike Damage 2 - Range 0
Leveling Winds Damage 1 Range 2 - Force to resist failure knocked over

EXAMPLES OF CONFLICTS

- A tengu has been angered by the actions of a dishonorable student and is not found haunting the crossroads of a major village. It duels any lone travellers who attempt to gain entry to the village. The villagers need to identify who originally offended the Tengu or get the assistance of Daisan No Me to drive it away.
- An ancient shrine has opened its doors for the first time in a generation and young men and women of the local communities have been disappearing in small but increasing numbers ever since. Unbeknownst to the local governor the Tengu has been testing the young to see if any are worthy of its teachings, unfortunately it has found none who are worthy. Resulting in the death of the villagers.
- A group of young tengu have moved into the remains of a disused temple in the centre of town. Unlike older, more mature tengu, the young just enjoy playing tricks on the local inhabitants. Driving the villagers with their tricks and pranks. The group need to be driven out of the village and will not be easily removed. A older more mature Tengu living in the local forest might be persuaded to help by the Daisan No Me.

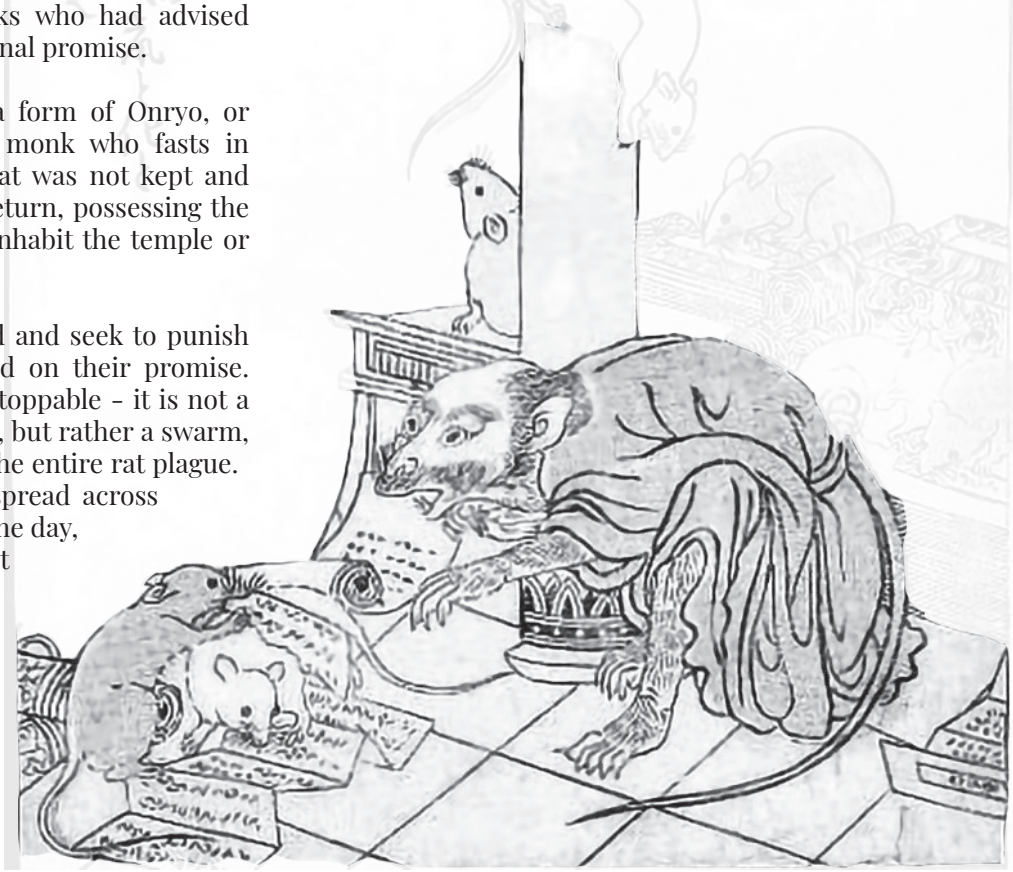
TESSO THE RAT

Along time ago, in the Province of Ise, a plague of rats drove the people to starvation and destroyed the wealth of the Ise Clan for generations - this is the story of Tesso. The Daimyo of Ise was a proud and arrogant man, given to false promises and lacking in honor. Ise was dry, no rains had come for two seasons, and the province faced being wiped out. Without rain, the Daimyo knew he would not be able to pay his taxes to the Shogun, bringing shame to his family and ending his control of the province. Luckily for him, Ise Province was the home of a famous Monk, Genro, whose prayers were known to reach straight to the heart of the gods. Ise Togashi, for that was the name of the Daimyo, made a promise to Genro, begging him to pray for an end to the drought. If the prayers were successful, Togashi committed to building a new shrine to Kannon in the center of Ise Province. Genro prayed for days, head bowed, chanting endless sutras to the Bodhisattva. The drought broke a week later, rains fell from the sky, watering the fields and saving the Daimyo. Genro waited for months, expecting the message from Ise Togashi announcing the building of the Shrine that was promised. It never came -the Daimyo had decided that Genro, a weaponless pacifist, was no threat. Genro, in anger at this betrayal refused to eat until Ise Togashi relented. Togashi, a cruel man, refused. In the end, Genro died, his body food for the rats that had come to the shrine he fasted in. Genro's spirit was angered by the arrogance of the Togashi and returned from Hell - possessing the rats who had eaten his body. The rats spread like a plague through Ise Province, destroying the crops and all the wealth of Ise Togashi. Nothing could stop them - their teeth were made of iron and their bodies like stone. Ise Province was rendered a wasteland by the arrogance of its Daimyo and the fury of a Holy Monk.

The Tesso is based on the story of the failed promise of the emperor to a most holy monk, whose prayers are said to have saved his son. Once cured, the Emperor was counseled against keeping his promise by monks of an opposing faction, leading to the death of the monk and his taking vengeance on both the Emperor and the monks who had advised against keeping the original promise.

Tesso, or Iron Rat, is a form of Onryo, or grudge spirit - a holy monk who fasts in protest at a promise that was not kept and who dies angered can return, possessing the bodies of the rats that inhabit the temple or shrine where they die.

Such spirits are angered and seek to punish the person who reneged on their promise. The Tesso is almost unstoppable - it is not a single creature anymore, but rather a swarm, its spirit spread across the entire rat plague. The Tesso swarm will spread across the land, hiding during the day, and coming out at night to devour all that was unfairly gained by the person who made the promise.



CONDITIONS

- Angered
- Mad
- Hateful
- Dispersed -1
- Scattered -2
- Broken - the rats fully disperse into the surrounding woods/buildings surrounding the site of the attack, the rat pack reforms at the end of the day.

MAGICAL ABILITIES

- Curse
- Endless - no matter how many rats are killed more rats will appear at nightfall, filling the ranks of the swarm.
- Instantly knows where things of value are
- Can destroy any material thing in a round
- Unstoppable - no barrier can stop the Tesso from gaining entrance

RITUAL

The Tesso must be appeased by granting that which was promised or it may be exorcised through the chanting of a priest or monk who knows the correct prayers.

SECRET

The Priest or Monk who chants must be a member in good standing of the order that the Tesso originally belonged to, who is holy and not worldly in any way. If an attempt is made to appease the Tesso, it will only be satisfied if the original promise maker sacrifices something of equal value to the original promise in addition to keeping the original agreement.

CHARACTERISTICS

Might: 7 Body Control: 8 Magic: 6
Manipulation: 4 Fear: 1

COMBAT

Bite / Swarm 2 Damage Range 0

EXAMPLES OF CONFLICTS

- In the Prefecture of Ise a Governor has made a promise he did not keep to the head priest of a shrine, his province is now at risk of falling to the Tesso's rage. He does not know it but simply making good on his original promise will not be enough to quell the rage of the Tesso.
- A family have angered a priest through their failure to keep promises that were made, they are kakure kirishitan, secret Christians, who are still outlawed on pain of death, however they believe that keeping those promises would be a sin against god.
- The Monk Hiroyuki was caught in a dispute with a Shinto shrine, using dark magics he has cursed himself to return as a Tesso and destroy the shrine. The priest of the shrine, Hotaka is begging the characters to come and save him as his own chants have no effect on the Tesso Swarm.

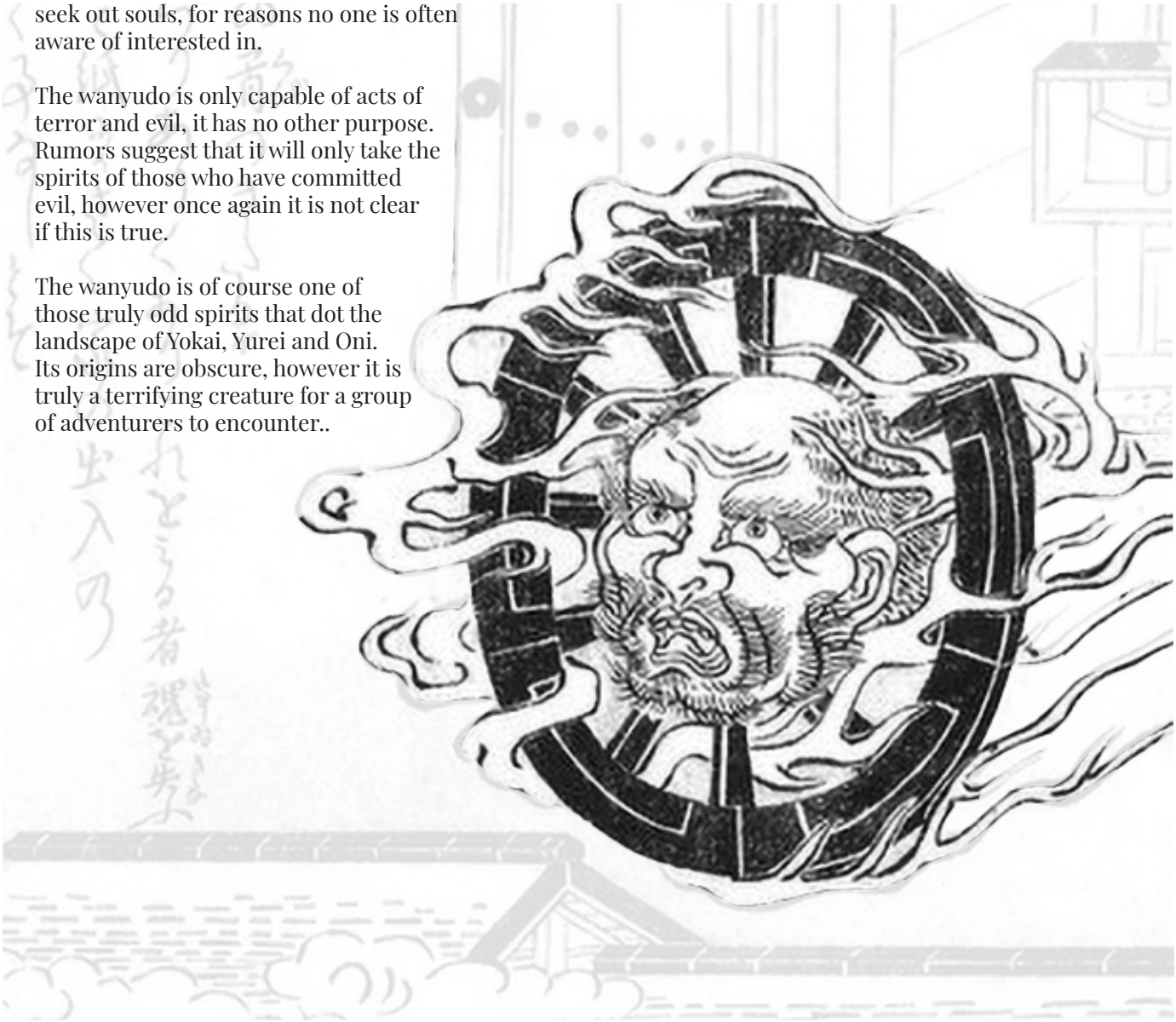
WANYUDO (FLAMING MONK)

A priest fell into hell once, and unlike many of his fallen brethren he was given a chance to make a different choice. Should he collect a thousand souls his travails would be over and his soul allowed to return to the great wheel of reincarnation. Unable to resist the call of the demon who offered him the deal he agreed. In an instant he found himself crossing the threshold of life, returned to the world above on special and auspicious nights for evil, he rolls from village to village, seeking those who have committed acts and evil. Should he find such people he is able to tear their spirits from their bodies, dragging them into hell to replace his now lost ledger. His visage is one that strikes fear into the heart of all those who see it, a screaming face wreathed in flame, trapped in the center of a wagon wheel that never ceases to roll while the sun is down.

A wanyudo is a creature from the very pits of Hell. A fallen monk unable to resist the pull of evil and often a victim of his own greed a wanyudo takes the form a wagon wheel wreathed in flame. It is driven to seek out souls, for reasons no one is often aware of interested in.

The wanyudo is only capable of acts of terror and evil, it has no other purpose. Rumors suggest that it will only take the spirits of those who have committed evil, however once again it is not clear if this is true.

The wanyudo is of course one of those truly odd spirits that dot the landscape of Yokai, Yurei and Oni. Its origins are obscure, however it is truly a terrifying creature for a group of adventurers to encounter..



CONDITIONS

- Rolling on
- Flaming rage +1 attack with fireballs
- Endless movement -1 ignore the next attack
- Ashen drive +1 increase speed
- Soul fire -1 initiate lashing attack
- A settled darkness -2 the wheel lays on its side, unable to move forward
- Broken - Driven to Darkness a fire pit opens up underneath the wheel taking it straight to hell. it will return on the next night and continue to roll forward.

MAGICAL ABILITIES

- Curse
- Enchant
- Fireball - the wheel launches unstoppable fireballs at its opponents
- Unstoppable - the wheel will not stop mirroring the endless cycle of reincarnation.
- Soul burn - the wheel is able to claim the souls of those who have transgressed against the tenets of their faith.

RITUAL

The wheel may be driven out by a holy person, who brings into effect the right sutras and chants. The wheel may also be appeased by the sacrifice of those who have done evil and may take its place in hell. Tricking the wheel into stopping rolling may also end the curse for a time.

SECRET

Digging up the body of the original priest is critical to driving him permanently back to hell and ensuring he continues to suffer for his crimes.

CHARACTERISTICS

Might: 12 Body Control:8 Magic: 8
Manipulation: 3 Fear: 3/1

COMBAT

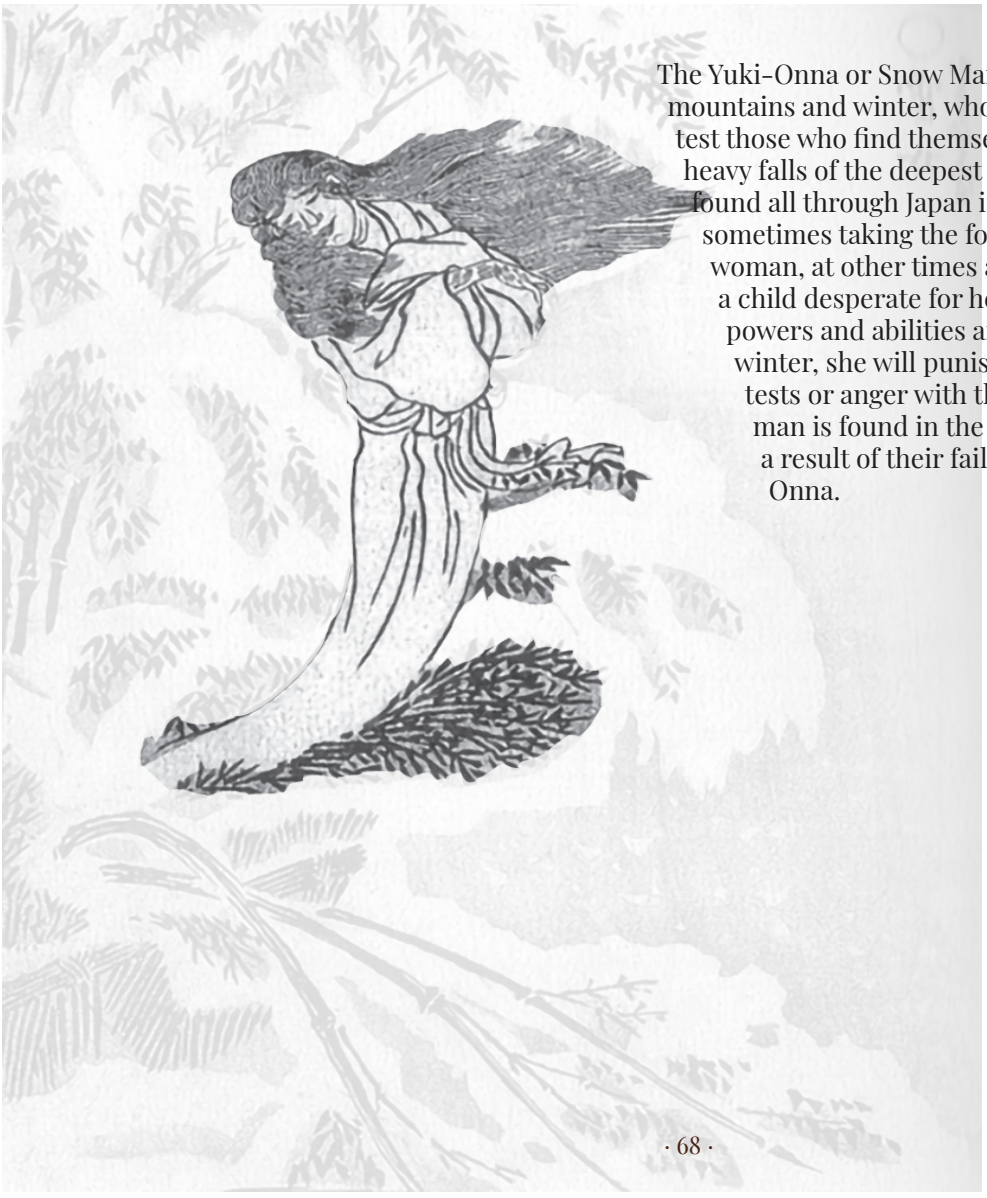
Crushing blow Damage 2 Range 1
Flaming blast Damage 2 Range 2 (Intensity 3 Fire)

EXAMPLES OF CONFLICTS

- A town has been attacked by a wanyudo and its return is already foretold by the local priest. The wheel is terrorizing the village and threatens to take many of the people in the village to hell when it returns.
- A monk who recently dies has returned from hell. His death was under suspicious circumstances but irrespective his vengeance on the community he formally served and stole from will be great.
- There is a pall over the usually festive ceremonies of the lunar celebration. Something is rising this year, something unnatural and its seeks only to injure and harm those who seek to honor their ancestors. It takes people at night when all are afraid to rise. Sometimes it takes children, sometimes adults without clear distinction or intent.

YUKI ONNA (SNOW MAIDEN)

A long time ago, deep in the snows of Niigata Province a hunter and his friends were shivering from the cold. The path to the cabin had become lost and they were blinded by the snowfall and the coming darkness as evening set. Afraid for their lives they called out repeatedly for help but no one came. The lead hunter, Asai Sora, noticed a bright light moving towards them from the darkness, calling out in desperation Sora was relieved to see a woman, with a small child on her back moving towards them with purpose. "How may I help you?" she asked, her voice falling across Sora's ears like the lightest of snow. Sora, desperate now and afraid of what was happening to his companion's whom he had lost sight of, begged the lady to help him. Her smile bright and enchanting captured his heart, "please just carry my child while I look for them, she begged." Sora grabbed the child who was smilingly happily and lifted it. As he followed the lady the child got heavier and heavier, his arms straining Sora just wanted to sit down and rest. However, he carried on, puffing and panting as his arms steadily weakened while the lady forged on ahead of him leaving him further and further behind. Suddenly the lady turned towards him, and gestured for him to put the child down, Sora let go of the child, clearly, you cannot carry them any further she said, Sora horrified by the thought rejected the lady's suggestion even though the child suddenly doubled in weight. Again she suggested he place the now unmoving and freezing child on the ground and once again Sora, now aching and shivering resisted her call. Finally, the lady, exasperated strode towards him and demanded he abandon the child, Sora, breathing what he was sure were his last breaths rejected her again. Even as he fell into the snow, exhausted, he held the child above his head. Suddenly the snow cleared, the lady gently lifted him up, lifting the child, now clearly made of ice and snow from his arms. Sora never really knew what the woman had intended, but it was clear had he allowed the child to fall, he himself would never have risen again.



The Yuki-Onna or Snow Maiden is a Yurei of the mountains and winter, who uses her powers to test those who find themselves lost amongst the heavy falls of the deepest part of winter. She is found all through Japan in one form or another, sometimes taking the form of a beautiful woman, at other times a lost mother carrying a child desperate for help. In any case, her powers and abilities are tied to the snow and winter, she will punish those who fail her tests or anger with those powers. Often a man is found in the morning frozen solid as a result of their failing the tests of Yuki-Onna.

CONDITIONS

- Insulted +1
- Summon a storm
- Enraged +2
- Hail falls in the area
- Frightened -1
- Badly hurt -2
- Broken (vanishes into fog and reappears in the heart of the forest after 1D6 hours)

MAGICAL ABILITIES

- Enchantment: Yuki Onna may use Enchantment to exert control over the weather and to bring about the effects of the cold on others. They may choose to make items of ice and cold at will.
- Weather control: The Yuki Onna may summon winter storms, sleet and ice at a moments notice. Their power over the winter weather is significant, however they cannot control the weather at all during Summer and Spring.
- A Child's Weight: A Yuki Onna may summon the spirit of their lost child and place an enchantment on any who offer to carry it for them. With each mile the child is carried it doubles in weight, forcing the person carrying it to make successive Force tests. The number of successes required increases by one per mile. The person carrying the child must carry the child for three miles, taking a condition for every failed success. A person who is broken may die as they die of freezing conditions (roll physical Critical - Frostbite related injuries)

RITUAL

A Yuki Onna may be defeated by being exposed to high heat, especially in the form of a steaming bath or Hot Pool of water. If so treated it will melt into water within the pool of water and never return.

SECRET

The Yuki Onna is a distressed spirit, unlike many Yokai its origins are tied to a human experience that drove the woman to suicide. For a Yuki Onna to completely defeated, never returning it must either be loved or have vengeance on the person/s who drove it to suicide in the first place.

CHARACTERISTICS

Might: 8 Body Control: 9 Magic: 10
Manipulation: 10 Fear: 0

COMBAT

Freezing Touch: Damage 2 Range 0 (Its touch is like frozen fire)
Winter's Breath : Damage 2 Range 2 (A freezing mist seeps out of the body of the Yuki Onna)

EXAMPLES OF CONFLICTS

- A Yuki Onna has been stalking the Mountains for weeks striking at hunters cabins. It persuades the hunters to let it in, just before they sleep and feeds off of their heat. Normally it leaves no one alive, however in its last attack it has left the youngest of the hunters alive, having become entranced by his beauty. The Yuki Onna will seek to persuade him to marry it, whilst continuing to attack hunters in the forest.
- A woman and child are stranded by the side of the road, their cart has been overturned by the wind and they need help getting home. The party will offer aid not realising the woman is in fact a Yuki Onna and she asks each in turn to carry the child. If they refuse she will attack them with her magic for they are clearly without morals. If one or more offers to help they will need to survive the Child's Weight or die in the attempt.
- A young woman who was promised in marriage to the local official has gone missing. Unbeknownst to all she has fled the marriage as the official is both arrogant and cruel. Her place has been taken by a Yuki Onna who intends to exact revenge on the man for his part in her death several years ago.

Life Paths



Step 1	Roll (d66) or choose from the Caste Table	So, if you roll a 41 on the d66 you will be from the Farmer caste RESOURCES 2 STATUS 3
Step 2	Roll (d6) on the Upbringing table for the caste of your character: 1. Write down your attributes based on the roll. 2. Write down your skills based on the roll. 3. Write down your starting resources based on the roll.	Next you roll a 5 on the Upbringing: Farmers and Fishermen Table. The result is Cattle Farmer. PHYSIQUE 3 PRECISION 3 LOGIC 4 EMPATHY 5 INVESTIGATION 1 LEARNING 1 MANIPULATION 1 OBSERVATION 1 RESOURCES 5
Step 3	Roll on the Great Shift Table for your caste (d6) (to ascertain how well your character survived the end of the Shogunate and the rise of the Meiji Regime).	You then roll a 1 on the Great Shift Table: Farmers and Fisherman (Negative outcome / -1 Status, -2 Resources, -1 Profession Roll). STATUS 2 RESOURCES 3
Step 4	Roll (d6) on the Profession Table for your caste and note down your profession.	Next you roll a 4 the Farmer Profession Table and apply the -1 for the Negative outcome, which results in a 3. You get Priestess as your profession.
Step 5	Roll on the life event table for your profession. 1. Write down the skills you get based on the roll. 2. If you get more than 2 in a skill that is not in your profession's main skill, you must raise your profession's main skill instead (up to 3). If your main skill reaches 3, you may instead raise a skill of your choice up to 2. 3. Write down the equipment you get based on the roll.	You then roll a 1 on my Life Event Table (for Priestess) you get Encounter with Hiningen-teki: LEARNING 1 OBSERVATION 1 You also receive a Chochin as equipment.
Step 6	You are now Young. You may now start the game (go to step 8) or make another roll for Life Events and become Middle-Aged (repeat step 5, then go to step 7).	You choose to roll again on Life Event Table for Miko. You roll a 3 giving you Feud: FORCE 1 VIGILANCE 1 And Make-up as equipment
Step 7	You are now Middle-Aged. Lower an attribute of your choice by one. You may now start the game (go to step 9) or make another roll on the Life Events Table, and become old (repeat step 5, then go to step 8).	You lower your Physique by one, and decide to roll again on the Miko Life Event Table. You roll a 5 giving you Forbidden Love: STEALTH 1 MANIPULATION 1 And a Calligraphy Set as equipment.

Step 8	You are now old. Lower an attribute of your choice by one. No attribute may start at zero. You must now start the game (go to step 9).	This time you lower your Empathy from 5 to 4.
Step 9	You may move one attribute point as you see fit, up to 5 in your profession's main attribute.	You make no changes to your stats.
Step 10	You may spend four extra skill points as you see fit, up to 3 in your profession's main skill.	You decide to spend the 4 remaining skill points to your existing skills. You choose: INSPIRATION 0 + 1pt = 1 INVESTIGATION 1 +1pt = 2 OBSERVATION 2 + 1pt = 3 STEALTH 1 + 1pt = 2 FORCE 1 LEARNING 2 MANIPULATION 2 VIGILANCE 1
Step 11	Refer to the Archetypes Section. Roll d3 for each of the following or choose your own Profession, Motivation, Trauma, Dark Secret and Talent. Count from the top down, based on the examples in the profession descriptions.	Refer to the Priestess Archetype. You roll a d3 for each and you get the following: Profession – Itako Motivation - Connect the living and the dead Trauma - My family was killed by an angry Yurei who felt I had failed them. Dark Secret - I cannot control my powers Talent - Kuchiyose.
Step 12	Choose an extra item from the equipment listed under the profession descriptions.	Item – Spirit box.

Final Character Summary:

Archtype: Priestess Profession: Itako Motivation: Connect the living and the dead Trauma: My family was killed by an angry Yurei who felt I had failed them. Dark Secret: I cannot control my powers Talent: Kuchiyose	Attributes: Physique 2 Precision 3 Logic 4 Empathy 4	Skills: Force 1 Inspiration 1 Investigation 2 Learning 2 Manipulation 2 Observation 3 Stealth 2 Vigilance 1	Equipment: Calligraphy set Chochin Make-up Spirit Box



Caste Table:

Result	Caste	Status	Starting Resources
63 - 66	Member of a Royal Court	5	5
53 - 62	Warrior (Bushi)	4	3
41 - 52	Farmer	3	2
31 - 36	Artisan	2	2
21 - 26	Merchant	1	4
11 - 16	Eta (Untouchable Caste)	0	1

Character Upbringing Tables

Upbringing: The Royal Courts

Fate has smiled upon you this day, for you have been born into one of many royal courts that permeated Edo Japan—the pinnacle of the warrior caste and part of the upper oligarchy of Japan. Your birth is celebrated, and your name is written and cataloged in the great Book of Days. Servants tend to your every need, and all the amenities you could ever hope for are at your disposal. It is hard for you to relate to the lower castes, but it matters not, because your many servants will do so for you.

Roll	Result	Description	Stats	Skills
1	Ministry of Ceremonies	Family names are not just an important aspect of Japanese Society—they are crucial. In a world where names mean everything, your father was one of many whose job it was to keep and catalogue the names of the most important in your caste. Your family was not wealthy by the standards of the court, but still had more than most others in Japan.	Physique 3 Precision 3 Logic 4 Empathy 5	LEARNING 1 VIGILANCE 1 INSPIRATION 1 MANIPULATION 1 RESOURCES + 0
2	Ministry of the Treasury	With the unification of Japan under the Shogunate, came a period of unprecedented economic growth for the country. Your father worked in the Ministry of Treasury, responsible for tax collection, the prices of commodities, and the minting of coins. As your father was in the heart of the economic activity of the court, you lived in place of comfort and wealth even when compared to others in your caste.	Physique 3 Precision 4 Logic 5 Empathy 3	LEARNING 1 VIGILANCE 1 OBSERVATION 1 MANIPULATION 1 RESOURCES + 1
3	Court Official	Keeping the country running and unified, relied on official government workers like your father. The Daimyo's voice was carried across the lands through the seals your father used on his behalf. You lived comfortably near the castle walls, and your father was paid well enough to employ your own servants, provide fish to eat, and pay for fine clothing.	Physique 4 Precision 3 Logic 4 Empathy 4	CLOSE COMBAT 1 LEARNING 1 VIGILANCE 1 MANIPULATION 1 RESOURCES + 0
4	Military Commander	Your family was the elite of the elite, a trusted commander in the Daimyo's army. Many Bushi served your father, and he was granted lands by the Daimyo to feed and pay his soldiers. You grew up in a castle town, possibly along the Tokaido Road between Kyoto and Edo, or within one of many clan territories. While not as present in people's lives as the Machi- bugyo your family was feared and respected throughout the land.	Physique 5 Precision 4 Logic 3 Empathy 3	AGILITY 1 CLOSE COMBAT 1 FORCE 1 RANGED COMBAT 1 RESOURCES + 0

5	Down the line	You grew up down the line of succession, and your father never gave you nearly as much attention as your older brother. You tended to find yourself spending more time with your mother and in your studies. While you were trained in the art of combat, it did not become a focal point of your life as it did with your older siblings. You instead chose to spend your time chasing after lovers, drinking and enjoying literature. You cared little for politics and only sought self-gratification.	Physique 3 Precision 4 Logic 4 Empathy 4	RANGED COMBAT 1 CLOSE COMBAT 1 MANIPULATION 1 OBSERVATION 1 RESOURCES + 0
6	Heir	You grew up with your father's overbearing expectations breathing down your neck, and you were expected to one day lead your family's dynasty. To you, wielding a blade and a bow came as fluently as putting an ink brush to paper. You put 100% into everything you did, for that is what was expected of you. Hours of long lectures on the strategies of warfare as well as governance, filled your days.	Physique 4 Precision 4 Logic 3 Empathy 4	RANGED COMBAT 1 CLOSE COMBAT 1 MANIPULATION 1 INSPIRATION 1 RESOURCES + 1

Upbringing: Warrior (Bushi)

You have been lucky enough to be born into the warrior caste of Japan. You are the son or daughter of a Bushi, a warrior who, through the local Daimyo, receives a yearly stipend. As Bushi, you are expected to be willing to die to protect the Daimyo and the Emperor or Shogun. Your life is rich with traditions and the expectations of your caste. Boy or girl, you live a comfortable life, even the poorest Bushi is expected to have a house, servants and silk clothes which the stipend sometimes funds. The stipend, especially towards the end of the Tokugawa Era was never enough to fund your lifestyle, many Bushi families sold goods just to get by. Even as a child, you wore the Daisho (big little) a paired set of swords. The big blade is known as a Katana, while the smaller blade a Wakizashi. Only your caste, the Bushi, were granted the right to wear both of these swords. It is what distinguishes you from the commoners. They not only provided you protection from physical harm, but just the sight of the Daisho was enough to grant you complete immunity in your dealings with the lower castes.

Roll	Result	Description	Stats	Skills
1	Foot Soldier	You grew up an Ashigaru (a spear warrior). Your family was poor by Bushi standards making a small amount of Koku and barely making ends meet. You despised the Merchants and Artisans who, while lower caste, were better fed and educated than yourself. You trained in the arts of combat every day as a child as it was your only solace from the poverty that you could never escape.	Physique 5 Precision 4 Logic 3 Empathy 3	AGILITY 1 CLOSE COMBAT 2 RANGED COMBAT 1 RESOURCES -2

2	Dōshin (Police)	Your father was a Dōshin, a keeper of the peace in the cities of the Shogunate. As a Dōshin he represented law and order to the lower castes and was responsible for carrying out investigations into crimes of thievery and murder, as well as helping with executions. He was absent most days and was rarely home. You spent your time with your mother helping around the house when you were not studying, indulging in literature or chasing lovers.	Physique 4 Precision 4 Logic 3 Empathy 4	CLOSE COMBAT 1 LEARNING 1 INSPIRATION 1 OBSERVATION 1 RESOURCES -1
3	Bushi of a small fishing village	Your family presided over a small fishing village along the coast. The people tried their best not to make eye contact with you as you moved around the village. You didn't care what the peasantry thought, for they lived in a different world to yours. Your father was a harsh man, who frequently punished those he felt had stepped out of line. You were often called upon to watch the punishment he meted out to those who were less than you.	Physique 4 Precision 5 Logic 3 Empathy 3	AGILITY 2 CLOSE COMBAT 1 RANGED COMBAT 1 RESOURCES -1
4	Bushi of a large farm town.	You grew up with the knowledge that you would one day inherit your father duties, titles and land. Your family governed over a substantial and wealthy farming town, from which your family drew their annual salary in Koku. You were well fed and well trained in the art of combat. You knew that your privilege came at a price, and that is to live and die for your Daimyo. Your mother worried that one day you would be called upon to offer up your life in service, but knows that family honor transcends one's own life.	Physique 4 Precision 3 Logic 4 Empathy 4	CLOSE COMBAT 1 FORCE 1 OBSERVATION 1 VIGILANCE 1 RESOURCES + 1
5	Yoriki (Patrol Leader)	Working under the Machi-bugyō was your father, a Yoriki (a patrol leader). He was responsible for managing all the Bushi who worked under him in the city. He always looked so tall upon his horse as he rode through the streets. One day you will be taller than anyone on a horse, tall and strong just like your father. The assignments that pass through your hands will be of high importance, and from your horse, you will carry them out with the greatest of ease.	Physique 4 Precision 4 Logic 3 Empathy 4	CLOSE COMBAT 1 LEARNING 1 MANIPULATION 1 OBSERVATION 1 RESOURCES + 0

6	Machi-bugyō (Chief Administrator)	Generations of servitude and loyalty to your Daimyo had earned your father the title of Machi-bugyo, one of the cities lead administers. Your father was the chief of police, prosecutor and chief justice for both criminal and civil cases. You were incredibly wealthy and employed a house full of servants to fulfill your family's needs and wishes. The might and authority of your lord passed through your father. People both feared and respected your family. Despite this, your father valued the work of the Eta who helped him extract the truth from criminals, and you have had dealings with these lower caste people.	Physique 4 Precision 3 Logic 4 Empathy 4	CLOSE COMBAT 1 INVESTIGATION 2 VIGILANCE 1 RESOURCES + 1

Upbringing: Farmers and Fishermen

You may not have lived in luxury like the Bushi. You may not have been as wealthy as an Artisan or especially a Merchant, but you were important none the less. The food you provided for your Daimyo and your local lords was crucial for the prosperity of the kingdom. The blood and sweat that you put into your labor, whether it be agricultural, or fishing was respected, you are high caste as a result, with only the Bushi above you. Your days were long but gratifying, and your communities were stable and supportive. In the hard times however, you could starve and had to struggle for food and protection. Famine was a frequent enemy and the Emperor, the Shogun and the Daimyo all extract their pound of flesh from you in the form of harsh taxes.

Roll	Result	Description	Stats	Skills
1	Radish Farmer	You lived too far away from the coast to ever know the taste of fish. Your family struggled to survive off of the food they grew, which unfortunately was the Daikon, a giant white radish. You worked long hours from dawn to dusk cultivating and harvesting the fields in the hope you would make enough to last another winter. Your family did not have much, and so were treated as almost sub-human by the Bushi family that watched over the village.	Physique 5 Precision 3 Logic 3 Empathy 4	AGILITY 1 FORCE
2	Seaweed Farmer	Your family ran a small seaweed farm, it was not much, but it paid enough for you to get by. The mouth of a river is the best place to grow seaweed using bamboo branches and the wild spores to complete the growing cycle, which is why your first memory is of the sound of gulls on the wind. You were always surrounded by water and you remember the rituals of daily and yearly life fondly. You learned to swim and walk amongst the river reed and sandbanks when others, less fortunate than you, were scrabbling in the dirt.	Physique 4 Precision 4 Logic 4 Empathy 3	AGILITY 2 STEALTH 1 VIGILANCE 1 RESOURCES + 0

3	Fisherman	Life was peaceful for you and your family. You grew up along the coastline where the warm wet salty air sticks to your nostrils and hair, for your father was a fisherman, like his father before him. As a child, you formed many fond memories of you and your siblings walking out into the harbor during low tide in search for shellfish to take back home to your mother to eat and sell at the market.	Physique 5 Precision 4 Logic 4 Empathy 2	AGILITY 1 FORCE 1 RANGED COMBAT 1 STEALTH 1 RESOURCES + 0
4	Rice Farmer	Your family had farmed this plot of land for generations. The surplus of rice your family cultivated provided your Daimyo with food to feed his garrisons and pay the local Bushi retainers, thus earning the respect of the warrior caste. Under their protection, your family lived a comfortable and safe existence, except during the hard years when no one was more valued than the Daimyo's own family.	Physique 5 Precision 4 Logic 2 Empathy 4	FORCE 2 STEALTH 1 OBSERVATION 1 RESOURCES + 0
5	Cattle Farmer	Your family owned a large cattle farm. Farmers and merchants would come to your farm to purchase draft animals for labor and transportation. You raise them as calves and trained them in operating farming equipment or in the pulling of carts. Your least favorite part was cleaning and collecting the manure to sell to farmers, but you could usually sneak away and just have one of your father's servants do it for you. Cattle, while not as lucrative as selling horses, paid far more than selling rice or fish, for which you thanked the ancestors daily.	Physique 3 Precision 3 Logic 4 Empathy 5	INVESTIGATION 1 LEARNING 1 MANIPULATION 1 OBSERVATION 1 RESOURCES + 2
6	Stable master	Your family ran and owned a large horse ranch where you bred and sold horses to the Bushi. You rode a horse before you could walk and the saddle was your second home. A horse, especially one raised by yourself was like a brother or sister and you were always saddened when they were sold. Wealthy beyond any others of your caste, your father employed many workers and servants. No matter what the rice farmers believed you knew, your family was the one the Bushi truly valued, for without a horse a Bushi was just another Ashigaru, a lowly spear carrier without respect or opportunity.	Physique 5 Precision 4 Logic 2 Empathy 4	AGILITY 1 FORCE 2 OBSERVATION 1 RESOURCES + 3

Upbringing: Artisan

Your family may not be as respected or as appreciated as the farmer who tills the rice paddies. However, the work your parents did was still essential to the prosperity of the domain, gaining your family respect. Maybe your family were smiths creating firearms or pole arms. Perhaps they crafted shoes, musical instruments, maybe even toys for children. You were taught how to take a raw thing and shape it into a new thing of utility and beauty, giving you not only satisfaction in your career, but the respect of your community.

Roll	Result	Description	Stats	Skills
1	Ceramic Artist	Your father and mother were simple ceramic artisans. They spent their days creating a multitude of beautiful works of art, from small shrine tokes and bowls to the exquisite tea kettles used for tea ceremonies. Your family's finished works adorn many homes in the city..	Physique 3 Precision 5 Logic 3 Empathy 4	AGILITY 2 INSPIRATION 2 RESOURCES + 0
2	Ukiyo-e Artist	Your family belongs to one of the great Ukiyo-e schools, and you were trained in the arts of print making, drawing and painting from a young age. You started, like all members of your family by practicing the most basic of skills, making wrappers for sweets. You had learned how important your school was and your apprenticeship to a great Ukiyo-e Master seemed assured.	Physique 3 Precision 4 Logic 3 Empathy 5	LEARNING 1 INSPIRATION 2 OBSERVATION 1 RESOURCES + 0
3	Lumber worker	It does not pay as well as other jobs, but it is good honest work, and many generations of peace under the Tokugawa reign led to higher and higher demand for more and more wood. The country was built with every tree your family cut down, bringing your father a tremendous amount of pride with every stroke of his saw and swing of his axe.	Physique 5 Precision 4 Logic 3 Empathy 3	AGILITY 1 FORCE 2 VIGILANCE 1 RESOURCES - 1
4	Carpenter	You come from a long line of well-known carpenters. Your family employed many workers, and you grew up helping and learning the skills of his craft. Every 30 years, many temples need to have their roofs rebuilt, and they call on your family, who have been doing this work for generations.	Physique 4 Precision 4 Logic 3 Empathy 4	AGILITY 1 FORCE 1 INSPIRATION 1 OBSERVATION 1 RESOURCES + 0

5	Gunsmith	When the Portuguese first taught your family the secrets to making black powder, your family rose in stature. Other artisans especially blade smiths looked upon your family with envy. The power that you gave to armies was unmatched by any bow, which took years of training to master. Your family produced a weapon that was capable of toppling Daimyos, creating envy and fear amongst the Bushi. You lived under constant guard, your weapons were controlled, and you were never allowed the freedom that others had access to.	Physique 4 Precision 5 Logic 4 Empathy 2	RANGED COMBAT 2 INVESTIGATION 1 LEARNING 1 RESOURCES + 1
6	Royal Sword smith	You were born into a family of sword smiths, master crafts people and treasured above all others by the Bushi. You felt trapped in the place that you lived in, even as you learned the arts of the sword. Your training extended beyond the crafting of the weapons you made to their actual use. While you lived amongst the family your prodigious skills with the sword were a hidden from your masters, for such skill would have been an insult to Bushi honor.	Physique 4 Precision 5 Logic 4 Empathy 2	CLOSE COMBAT 2 INVESTIGATION 1 OBSERVATION 1 RESOURCES + 2

Upbringing: Merchant

You were lucky, or unlucky to be born into the lowest level of Japanese Society. Unlike the Farmers and Artisans, who's sweat and blood goes into the items they sow or create for monetary gain, your family, on the other
hand, is capable of making vast amounts of wealth without ever breaking a drop of sweat. Maybe your father is a merchant who sails to Korea or China, buying spices and cloth. Perhaps he has connections in dealings with foreigners who bring in exotic goods from across the vast oceans from the few ports that are allowed to open to such trade. More likely, your family made a living by taking goods produced through the hard work of one family and selling it to people in the large cities and towns. While you are quite capable of living luxuriously through these practices, the people look down upon you for this, the Bushi especially.

Roll	Result	Description	Stats	Skills
1	Tinkerer	You grew up as one of the itinerant merchants who traveled the back roads of Japan, looking for a bargain amongst the villages no one else would touch. You learned much during your time on the road, but have suffered many sicknesses and come close to starving many times. These experiences taught you well and in your heart, you still love the quite roads and back alleys of small villages.	Physique 2 Precision 4 Logic 5 Empathy 4	MEDICINE 1 LEARNING 2 VIGILANCE 1 RESOURCES -1

2	Trader	Buy low and sell high - that was the first thing your father taught you growing up. Your family lived on selling anything from farming equipment to shoes and clothing. It was important that you could quickly take your goods from one place to another, looking for opportunities in the towns and cities, making just enough profit to survive another year.	Physique 3 Precision 4 Logic 4 Empathy 4	FORCE 1 MANIPULATION 2 OBSERVATION 1 RESOURCES + 0
3	Fishmonger	Your family bought from the local fishermen who came into the port every morning and afternoon. It was an easy job, and your family was able to make a fast and modest profit doing so. You learned to tell all of the fish, jellyfish and seaweeds apart, which were of the highest value and to whom. You have tasted the flesh of many sea creatures some perhaps stranger than others.	Physique 5 Precision 3 Logic 3 Empathy 4	FORCE 2 VIGILANCE 1 OBSERVATION 1 RESOURCES - 1
4	Silk trader	You will never forget when your father took you on your first voyage to China. The waves never bothered you growing up on your father's boat. What troubled you the most, was the sheer scale and volume of the ocean, a vast nothingness. It always amazed you how your father could even know east from the west out here, and over time, the confusion of being out at sea faded from your thoughts with each lesson your father gave to you. The silks your father was after are of a texture that could not be replicated in Japan. One trip could feed your family for a year and you lived in luxury, selling to the royal courts in Edo and Kyoto.	Physique 3 Precision 4 Logic 3 Empathy 5	LEARNING 1 INSPIRATION 1 MANIPULATION 1 OBSERVATION 1 RESOURCES + 1
5	Fire Arms Merchant	Your family bought firearms from the Dutch and the French, as the local firearms were no longer competitive with the foreign made guns. Your time with the Dutch was odd, they were ugly, unkempt and smelly. They were also masters of technologies and sciences that were beyond anything you had yet discovered. You were afraid of what might be, these weapons were powerful and surely the Europeans used them as well. The Dutch told you not to worry. For Japan was still a powerful nation. You sought to warn your father about your fears and he laughed - yes, they had weapons, but we had the Shogun and, the Emperor, how could they even think of attacking us?	Physique 3 Precision 4 Logic 4 Empathy 4	RANGED COMBAT 1 INVESTIGATION 1 LEARNING 1 OBSERVATION 1 RESOURCES + 2

6	Red-light Merchant	Your family owned many pleasure houses, not that you were aware. Your home was in the merchant quarter and was filled with all bedding, clothing, refined goods and food that you could have ever asked for. Your great grandfather purchased his first building in the red-light district after earning enough money from a lifetime of successful trade ventures in China. You grew up receiving the best foods and education that money could buy, and your family's wealth afforded you a chance at pursuing a higher education in Edo when you got older.	Physique 4 Precision 3 Logic 3 Empathy 5	FORCE 1 MANIPULATION 1 OBSERVATION 2 RESOURCES + 2

Upbringing: Untouchable

Fate has not been kind to you or your family. You may have been born into this caste, or someone in your family committed a crime or took on a profession that was unclean, overnight your standing dropped to the very bottom tier of Japanese Society. You have no status. You are an untouchable, shunned by all others in Japanese Society, even the merchants will have nothing to do with you. Of course, should they need a body cleared away, or a prisoner executed they call upon you to do that which they will not!

Roll	Result	Description	Stats	Skills
1	Torturer	You were the trusted one, who could get even the strongest willed to change their tune. While you were despised by the general public, you were also feared. When the Doshin called, you came with your implements of persuasion to seek the truth or at worst to bring someone to justice and ensure ongoing harmony.	Physique 2 Precision 4 Logic 5 Empathy 4	FORCE 1
2	Beggar	You were a beggar on the street. Life was not been easy for you growing up, and you wondered every night where tomorrow's meal would come from. You managed to make it by begging, but your sister and brothers who were older, found it more and more challenging to bring home enough money to pay for food. Eventually they drifted away into the many criminal pathways or simply died on the street, struck down by some angry Bushi.	Physique 4 Precision 3 Logic 3 Empathy 5	AGILITY 1
3	Thief	You were branded a criminal by the Bushi, whether just or unjust you were forced to take what you needed to survive. You came into this world with nothing, and if you were not careful, you would leave it with nothing as well. Fate was not kind to you, but you refuse to stand on a street corner and beg for food.	Physique 4 Precision 5 Logic 4 Empathy 2	AGILITY 1 STEALTH 2 VIGILANCE 1 RESOURCES + 0

4	Sibling of a Prostitute	Your family lived well as farmers until a land dispute with a neighbor caused your family to lose half of their land. Left with land not large enough to cultivate adequately for farming, and with the threat of winter fast approaching, your family decided to sell their farm. The money gained was used to move into the city, with hopes of starting a business. Sadly however, that business failed, and your older sisters were left with no other choice but to offer themselves up for protection.	Physique 4 Precision 4 Logic 4 Empathy 3	AGILITY 1 FORCE 1 INVESTIGATION 1 VIGILANCE 1 RESOURCES + 0
5	Foreigner	Your family is Korean. You were allowed to live in Japan, unlike western foreigners, but you are not and could never be considered equal to the Japanese. Your family owned an inn and a restaurant downtown. Despite the social caste difference, you never had to worry about going hungry.	Physique 3 Precision 4 Logic 4 Empathy 4	LEARNING 1 VIGILANCE 1 MANIPULATION 1 OBSERVATION 1 RESOURCES + 0
6	Tanner	Your family ran a local tannery. Every morning, you helped your father skin animals, setting the hides up to dry during high noon. The stripping of flesh and the handling of dead animals goes against the country's religious practices, but someone has to do it. Besides, your father was given special privileges to hunt game, rewarded to your family many generations ago. On hunting outings with your father, you learned from a young age what it takes to track, shoot and skin wild game in forests and became quite proficient with both musket and bow. Your family also had access to the carcasses of not only freshly killed game, but that of cattle as well, allowing your family to travel from farm to farm, skinning and disposing of the corpses.	Physique 4 Precision 5 Logic 3 Empathy 3	FORCE 1 RANGED COMBAT 2 VIGILANCE 1 RESOURCES + 1



THE GREAT SHIFT

The fall of the Tokugawa and the end of the Bushi hit Japanese society like a steam train. It made and destroyed lives, upending a thousand years of tradition. Known as the Great Shift, many lost their livelihood during this change, while others thrived. Your rolls will have a negative, static, or positive outcome to your family's status and resources. It will be up to you to decide how the transition of power has affected your family. Maybe you are a Bushi who lost everything and is now forced to work alongside the people you once loomed over. Perhaps you are a merchant that, with his accumulation of wealth, and no longer shackled to a caste system, has used this position to seek an education and become a doctor. You decide the narrative that suits your character's life experience.

Outcome	**Status Impact**	**Resources Impact**	**Profession Roll Impact**
Negative	-1	-2	-1
Static	0	0	0
Positive	+1	+2	+1

Royal Court

The Tokugawa Shogunate has finally collapsed after 250 years and the power of the country's future now rests solely in the hands of the Emperor, a young boy 13 years of age. Thrust into the seats of tremendous powers seemingly overnight, he has no experience in the governance of a now unified Japan. There is a large power vacuum for new positions of power and governance for the upper echelons of Japan to step in and ease the burden that has been placed on the young Emperor's shoulders.

Roll	Outcome
1-2	Negative outcome: You have lost almost everything. You were caught up in the middle of a war over the control of the country. Your family, who swore allegiance to the Tokugawa dynasty, has found your titles removed and your estate almost completely dismantled and auctioned off to the people you once lorded over - the merchant caste.
3-4	Static outcome: Your family was neither lucky nor unlucky during the fall of the Tokugawa Shogunate. You are grateful that your clan's Daimyo did not join in the revolution, for after the ashes have fallen, you still maintain your family's wealth and independence. However, you have heard that a visitor from Kyoto, under the authority of the emperor, will soon come to govern your clan's domain.
5-6	Positive outcome: When the Emperor called out for support in overthrowing the Shogunate Dynasty, your clan was one of the first to gather up its forces and join the call to arms. The loyalty that your clan has shown to the Emperor has been greatly rewarded after the Tokugawa collapse. Your Daimyo has been allowed to keep control over his dominion, and your clan has prospered and joined the oligarchy.

Warriors (Bushi)

High ranking Bushi of Daimyos who allied themselves with the Emperor have been given a chance to adjust comfortably into the new world, whether it be joining the military in positions of authority, or even the oligarchy. Most Bushi, however, have had their world completely shattered. The new reforms that have come from Kyoto have destroyed the caste system overnight. Bushi, who have lived very comfortably with yearly stipends and positions of authority over the lesser castes, have now found themselves without income and purpose.

Roll	Outcome
1-3	Negative outcome: Your Daimyo has had his titles taken from him, and your family now finds itself unemployed. Without income or the ability to collect rice from the farmer caste, your family is forced to downsize and sell large portions of their estate. Your parents are afraid of being unable to provide you with a future.
4	Static outcome: Your family was neither lucky nor unlucky during the fall of the Tokugawa Shogunate. You are grateful that your clan's Daimyo did not join in the revolution, for after the ashes have fallen, you still maintain your family's wealth and independence. However, you have heard that a visitor from Kyoto, under the authority of the emperor, will soon come to govern your clan's domain.
5-6	Beneficial outcome: Your father was not only lucky to have been serving under a Daimyo loyal to the Emperor but managed to earn a position of high stature from his years of service, loyalty and his tremendous acts of leadership he showed on and off the battlefield. Your father is now comfortably seated in a position of power and influence, giving you a tremendous advantage in this world.

Farmers and Fishermen

The Farmer and Fishermen caste, while they may not experience the harsher changes of the shift, still find it difficult to move on from what they have been doing for hundreds of years. The few that do decide to leave and seek new fortunes do so, but only to end up transitioning from a back-breaking job in the fields to one in the many factories that have begun to take over the cities.

Roll	Outcome
1-2	Negative outcome: The transition of power was not good for your family's income. Your family has had to overcome a lot over the years just to get by and survive. Starvation is a constant threat before each winter.

3-4	Static outcome: While the system of government has changed and you no longer have the Bushi caste looming over you and your family, the transition of government has not affected your family. You still maintain the same routine every year.
5-6	Beneficial outcome: You have been able to seek opportunities for employment in the city after you have finished your university education.

Artisans

The fall of the Tokugawa Shogunate has not caused much harm to the artisan caste. Even those that found themselves under the employment of radical Daimyos that have been struck down by the Emperor's loyalist forces have not been largely left alone.

Roll	Outcome
1	Negative outcome: A fire, started during one of the battles between the Tokugawa and the Imperial forces, severely damaged your family's home and business. Your parents are working day and night to be able to regain what they have lost.
2-4	Static outcome: The Meiji Restoration has occurred, abolishing the caste system; however, not much has changed for your family. The people your family provides their services to still come to you with constant requests.
5-6	Beneficial outcome: With the money, your family has managed to save up over the years, and the Emperor's gift to the people of an abolished caste system, your father has decided to extend the families revenue of income to that of other businesses and establishments. You are soon enjoying luxuries you never thought possible before the war.

Merchants

The end of the formal caste system means the Merchant caste can leverage its wealth and education to wield influence and power in previously unthinkable ways. The toppling of the Tokugawa Shogunate and the breaking of the caste system allowed the merchants to finally enjoy the same rights and privileges as those of the Bushi caste. With the tremendous amounts of wealth, merchants were able to quickly fill the power vacuum that was left behind in the wake of the collapsing traditional order. Merchants are now taking positions of governance and authority and quickly swelled the ranks of the oligarchy.

Roll	Outcome
1	Negative outcome: Your father made a terrible mistake in his investments - trying to recoup the losses, he gambled away a small fortune of your family's estate.
2	Static outcome: Your family has managed to ride out the fall of the Tokugawa Shogunate without losing or gaining a single coin.

3-6	Positive outcome: Your family has broad ambitions now that they are free of the caste system. Your father has taken this opportunity to invest heavily in many industries, and before you know it, you are eating cake with your parents at a banquet for the Oligarchy.

Untouchables	
The caste system has fallen, but it might as well be in place still, for the country's perception and treatment of you has not changed. While it is true that new sources of income now exist to you, such as joining the military or working in a factory, you still struggle both financially and socially.	
Roll	Outcome
1	Negative outcome: You have lost what little you had during the collapse of the economy. You have sold everything you could afford to and the social stigma associated with your history has meant you have been unable to find new work.
2-3	Static outcome: Things have managed to stay the same for you and your family. While it is true that the caste system is no longer in place, your family has not managed to break through decades of social conditioning.
4-6	Beneficial outcome: The caste system is gone, and your family has taken the utmost advantage of this new world order. Your parents have managed to take new positions of employment and invest to provide you with resources to help you succeed in life.



Profession Table

Additional Resources:

Royal Court	Boshi	Farmer	Artisan	Merchant	Untouchable	Archetype	Table
	0	0	0	0	0	Criminal	Table A (P220 Core Rules)
0	1	1		1	1	Servant	Table B (P221 Core Rules)
1		2	1	2	2	Entertainer	Table N (Extension)
		3			3	Shaman / Shrine Maiden	Table K (Extension)
	2	4	2		4	Hunter	Table C (P222 Core Rules)
2		5	3	3	5	Writer	Table G (P226 Core Rules)
3	3		4	4	6	Doctor	Table I (P228 Core Rules)
4	4					Warrior	Table J (Extension)
	5	6	5	5		Police	Table F (P225 Core Rules)
5			6			Priest	Table L (Extension)
6	6	7	7	6	7	Officer	Table E (P224 Core Rules)
7	7			7		Academic	Table M (Extension)

Life Event Tables

Warrior Life Event Table (Table J)			
D6	Event	Skills	Equipment
1	Injured: You were seriously injured and needed to recover for a long period of time. Whether you were shot in the middle of a battle or stabbed during a training bout. In any case your recovery was slow and painful.	FORCE 1 MEDICINE 1	Medical Equipment
2	Battle: You were a member of one of the units fighting in the civil wars or uprisings that have occurred over the last few years. Many of your fellow Bushi were killed in the battle, somehow you survived.	CLOSE COMBAT 1 FORCE 1	Naginata
3	Feud: A fellow Bushi took personal affront at your actions, resulting in a conflict that escalated to the point where it dragged in both of your families. Your conflict was not resolved but lives were lost on both sides, perhaps you found a way to move on, perhaps your feud continues.	CLOSE COMBAT 1 VIGILANCE 1	Katana
4	Captured: After one of the battles, you found yourself captured by the Imperial or Shogunate forces. After a period in prison, you were freed either by an amnesty or through the actions of a member of your forces. You owe your life to whoever freed you.	AGILITY 1 SNEAK 1	Chochin
5	Sweetheart: You met someone that made you happy and the love was reciprocated. Love gave your life meaning, and the future looked sparkling bright. Perhaps your sweetheart was from the floating world, a courtesan or a member of a noble family.	INSPIRATION 1 OBSERVATION 1	Calligraphy Set
6	Yu: You charged the enemy in accordance with the virtue of Yu driving your enemies before you and impressing the leaders of your forces. It may be that you were rewarded on the battlefield, that our entire unit was destroyed or that you turned the battle at that moment.	RANGED COMBAT 1 VIGILANCE 1	Strong Horse

Shaman / Shrine Maiden Life Event Table (Table K)			
D6	Event	Skills	Equipment
1	Encounter with Hi-ningenteki: you were called upon to drive a Yurei from one of the congregants of your shrine. The encounter was difficult, and the spirit did not go lightly into the night. Were you successful in driving the spirit out? Did you fail, allowing the spirit to continue its path of destruction?	LEARNING 1 OBSERVATION 1	Chochin
2	Fame: Your dance in service of the Kami became famous, drawing adherents from the local provinces to worship at the shrine. You are known for the beauty and elegance of your dance.	INSPIRATION 2	Musical Instrument
3	Feud: You have been feuding with a rival, perhaps from a different shrine or a government official. This conflict was a result of long-standing disagreements and was not easily resolved. It seems the conflict may not have ended in a way that resolved the conflict and the repercussions linger on.	FORCE 1 VIGILANCE 1	Make-up
4	Unearthed Secret: You have made a discovery relating to an old tale, one that was misunderstood by others. The discovery challenged the power of others, potentially upending long-held beliefs. What was the secret? Who were the people or organization that was affected by the change?	INVESTIGATION 1 OBSERVATION 1	Painted Scroll
5	Forbidden Love: While not sworn to celibacy relationships with people are not preferred, all Miko are expected to commit themselves to the shrine spirit they worship. You fell in love with the wrong person, perhaps a member of a lower caste, or perhaps a follower of another shrine or faith.	STEALTH 1 MANIPULATION 1	Calligraphy Set
6	Your own Shrine: You had reached the very pinnacle, the headship of your own shrine. You were in control of the worship and practice within the shrine and led all of the ceremonies. You lost control of the shrine at some point, why did this happen? Were you usurped from within or a victim of the Emperor's edicts?	MANIPULATION 1 OBSERVATION 1	Prayer Beads

Priest Life Event Table (Table L)			
D6	Event	Skills	Equipment
1	Doubt: You have read broadly and met many practitioners of different faiths. The government's attempt to define religion as a servant of the state has not sat well with you. You have doubts to resolve about your own faith or the direction of your shrine or temple.	LEARNING 1 INVESTIGATION 1	Painted Scroll
2	Popular: Your service within the shrine has become famous, drawing in believers from across the prefecture. Your preaching has transformed many lives and the government has reached out to you to support the message of the Emperor; how will you respond?	INSPIRATION 2	Shakujo or Prayer Beads
3	Feud: You have been feuding with a rival, perhaps from a different shrine or a government official. This conflict was a result of long-standing disagreements and was not easily resolved. It seems the conflict may not have ended in a way that resolved the conflict and the repercussions linger on.	STEALTH 1 VIGILANCE 1	Fancy Disguise
4	Unearthed Secret: You have made a discovery relating to an old tale, one that was misunderstood by others. The discovery challenged the power of others, potentially upending long held beliefs. What was the secret? Who were the people or organizations that was affected by the change?	LEARNING 2	Book Collection
5	Forbidden Love: You fell madly in love with the wrong person. Perhaps it was someone from a distinguished family, or perhaps the spouse of a friend. Your love was as passionate as it was doomed. You will never forget it.	STEALTH 1 MANIPULATION 1	Fine Sake
6	Your own Shrine: You had reached the very pinnacle, the headship of your own shrine. You were in control of the worship and practice within the shrine and led all of the ceremonies. You lost control of the shrine at some point, why did this happen? Were you usurped from within or a victim of the Emperor's edicts?	MANIPULATION 1 OBSERVATION 1	Rickshaw

Academic Life Event Table (Table M)			
D6	Event	Skills	Equipment
1	As per LIFE EVENT TABLE H in Core Rules		
2	Foreign Research Trip: You were selected to go overseas to research a topic of interest to the government. Your fact finding mission traveled to multiple western countries, examining how they do a particular thing. Your recommendations were either adopted or rejected by the government, which was it?	LEARNING 2	Chochin
3	As per LIFE EVENT TABLE H in Core Rules		
4	As per LIFE EVENT TABLE H in Core Rules		
5	As per LIFE EVENT TABLE H in Core Rules		
6	As per LIFE EVENT TABLE H in Core Rules		

Entertainer Life Event Table (Table N)			
D6	Event	Skills	Equipment
1	Addiction: You developed a severe addiction to some kind of substance. The need for the next fix consumed your life for some time. You made contacts in the underworld who ensured you got what you needed. Perhaps you finally broke free of your addiction, or maybe you remain its slave?	MANIPULATION 1 INSPIRATION 1	Opium
2	Patron: You were chosen by a wealthy benefactor who paid and housed you on the condition that you would continue to be their muse. You were kept in finery and given all you could want and more. It ended, but was it a mutual ending or does one of you still carry anger at how it ended?	OBSERVATION 1 STEALTH 1	Tea Set
3	Rival: You got into a lengthy conflict with a professional rival. You can barely remember how it started, but the conflict kept growing until it took over your life. Perhaps you got over it and became friends; perhaps you made an enemy for life.	INSPIRATION 1 VIGILANCE 1	Knife
4	Renown: You suddenly became famous. Perhaps the newspapers wrote stories about your Art or Practice, or maybe word of mouth spread regarding your beauty. With fame came both happiness and problems.	MANIPULATION 2	Shamisen

5	Sweetheart: You met someone that made you happy, and the love was reciprocated. Love gave your life meaning and the future looked sparkling bright. Your falling in love may have caused problems with your current patrons, or perhaps the family of your lover have accepted or rejected you.	INVESTIGATION 1 STEALTH 1	Calligraphy Set
6	Owner: You earned enough money or convinced a sponsor to allow you start your own business. It was not long before you had a room full of clients, hanging on every element of your performance. Perhaps you still own the premises?	INSPIRATION 1 AGILITY 1	Fine Sake